

BEGINNER

20 lessons · 108 puzzles · Solutions on page 39



Name: _____ Club / group: _____

Colour Key

**Basics**

How the pieces move and the must-know mates

**Attack**

Going for the King

**Defence**

Staying safe and stopping threats

**Endgame**

Few pieces left: finish the job

**Openings**

The first moves and good habits

**Rules**

Tournament rules and good manners

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 Games from the Lichess open database (CC0). Chess pieces: Noto Sans Symbols 2 (SIL Open Font License).

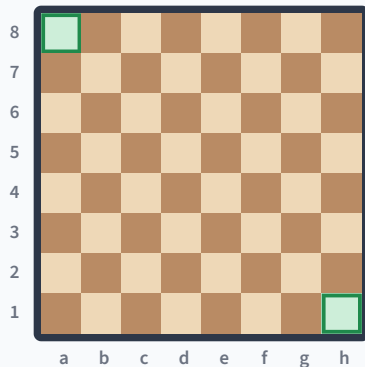
SETTING UP THE BOARD

The board, the pieces and where they go

Lesson 1 · Basics
Beginner Handouts

1. The Board

LIGHT SQUARE ON THE RIGHT

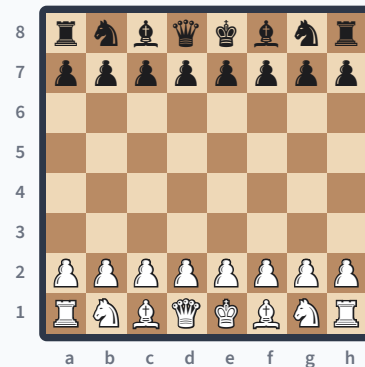


64 squares: 8 rows × 8 columns

- Turn the board so each player has a **light square in the bottom-right corner** (h1 and a8).
- Rows are **ranks** (1–8), columns are **files** (a–h).

2. The Starting Position

16 PIECES EACH



R N B Q K B N R

- **Rooks** in the corners, then **Knights**, then **Bishops**, then Queen and King in the middle.
- **Pawns** fill the whole next row: rank 2 for White, rank 7 for Black.

3. Queen on Her Colour

KINGS FACE EACH OTHER



White Queen d1 • Black Queen d8

- The White Queen stands on a **light** square, the Black Queen on a **dark** square.
- The Kings go next to their Queens on the **e-file**, facing each other.

4. Meet the Pieces

NAMES & VALUES

Piece	Name	Letter	How many	Worth
	King	K	1	Priceless
	Queen	Q	1	9
	Rook	R	2	5
	Bishop	B	2	3
	Knight	N	2	3
	Pawn	(none)	8	1

- The Knight is **N**, because K is already taken by the King.
- "Worth" helps you decide if a trade is good: a Rook (5) is worth more than a Bishop (3).

Set-Up Checklist

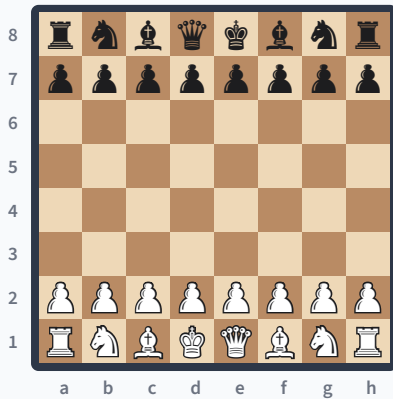
1. **Light on the right:** the bottom-right square (h1) must be a light square.
2. **Queen on her colour:** White Queen on the light square d1, Black Queen on the dark square d8.
3. **White always moves first.** Then players take turns, one move each.

PUZZLES: FIND THE MISTAKE

Each board has ONE set-up mistake... or maybe none!

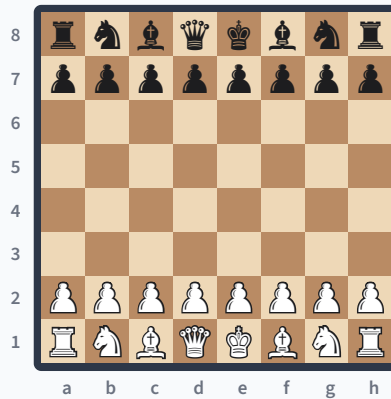
Lesson 1 · Basics Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

1 What is wrong with this set-up?



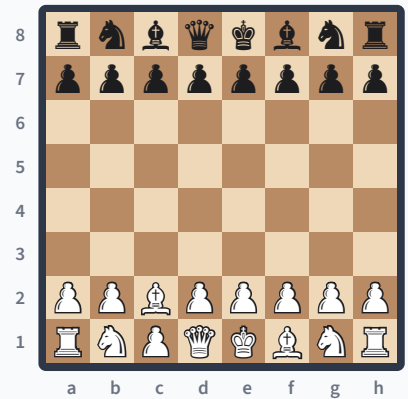
Answer: _____

2 What is wrong with this set-up?



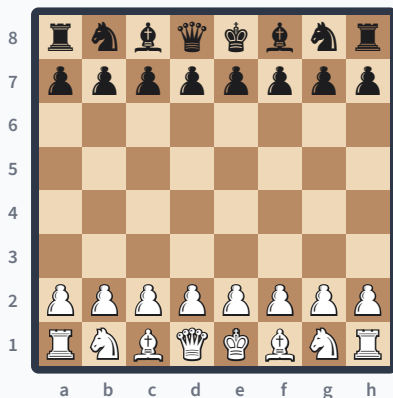
Answer: _____

3 What is wrong with this set-up?



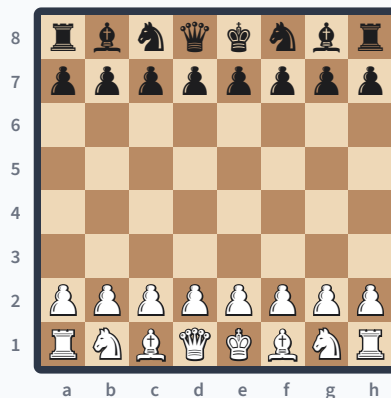
Answer: _____

4 What is wrong with this set-up?



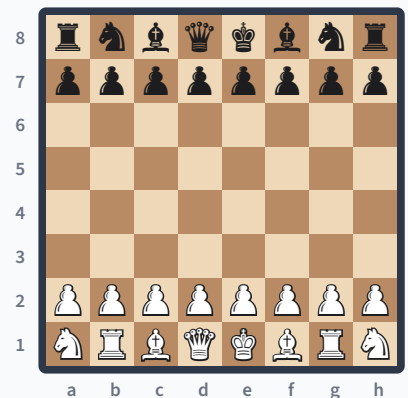
Answer: _____

5 What is wrong with this set-up?



Answer: _____

6 What is wrong with this set-up?



Answer: _____

Tip: check the corner square first, then the Queens, then each piece from the corners inward.

Score: ____ / 6

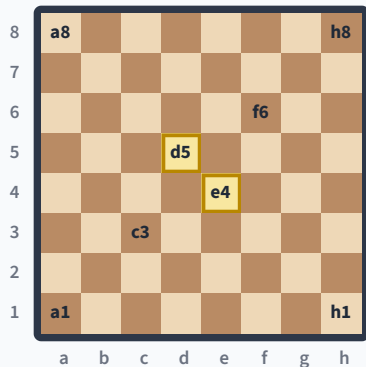
WRITING DOWN YOUR GAME

Chess notation: every square and every move has a name

Lesson 2 · Basics
Beginner Handouts

1. Every Square Has a Name

LETTER + NUMBER

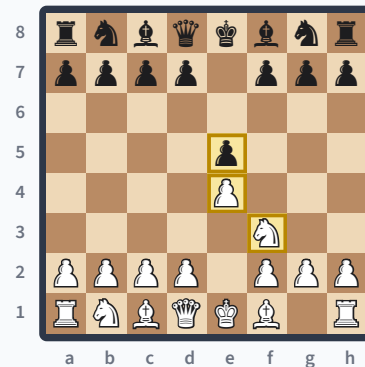


e4 = file e, rank 4

- Say the **letter** (file a–h) first, then the **number** (rank 1–8).
- White's pieces start on ranks 1 and 2, so a1 is always White's bottom-left corner.

2. Writing a Move

PIECE + SQUARE



1.e4 e5 2.Nf3

- Nf3** = Knight moves to f3. Write the piece's letter, then the square it goes to.
- Pawn moves are just the square: **e4**. Each move number has a White move and a Black move.

3. Special Symbols

X + # 0-0

Symbol	Means	Example
x	captures	Bxf7, exd5
+	check	Qh5+
#	checkmate	Qxf7#
0-0	castles kingside (short)	0-0
0-0-0	castles queenside (long)	0-0-0
=Q	pawn promotes to a Queen	e8=Q
!	a good move	Nd5!
?	a mistake	h6?
??	a blunder (big mistake)	Nf6??

4. A Scoresheet

SCHOLAR'S MATE

Move	White	Black
1	e4	e5
2	Bc4	Nc6
3	Qh5	Nf6??
4	Qxf7#	
5		
6		

- One row per move number: White's move on the left, Black's on the right.
- Write the result at the end: **1-0** (White wins), **0-1** (Black wins) or **½-½** (draw).

Why Write Your Moves?

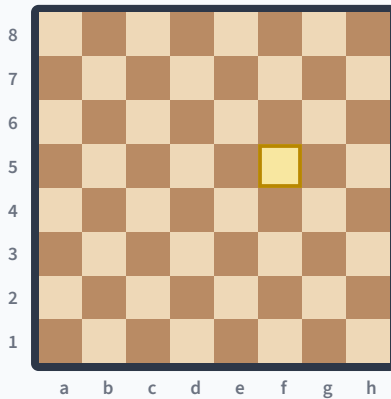
- Learn from your games:** replay them at home with your coach and find the mistakes.
- Tournaments need it:** in most tournaments you must keep score of every move.
- Move first, then write:** tournament rules say make your move on the board, then write it down.

PUZZLES: SQUARES & MOVES

Read the board, write it down

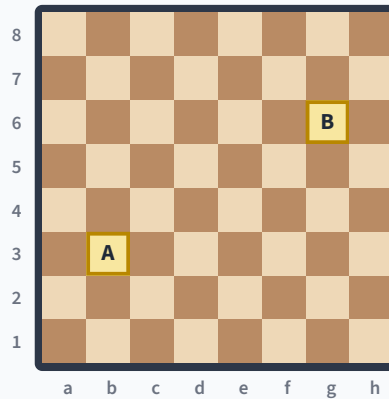
Lesson 2 · Basics Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

1 Name the yellow square.



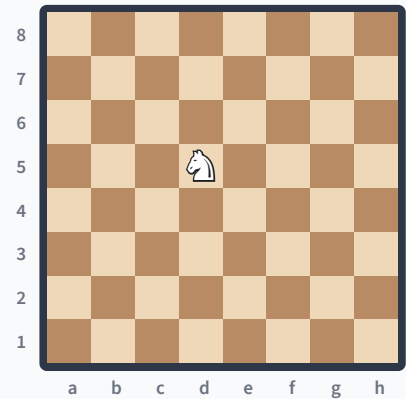
Answer: _____

2 Name the squares marked A and B.



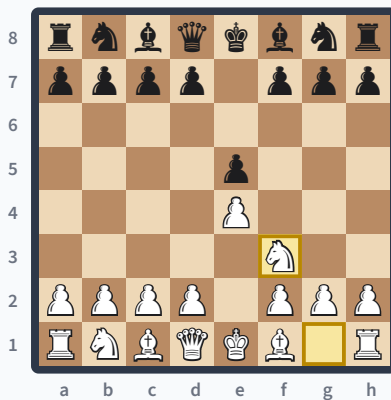
Answer: _____

3 On which square is the White Knight standing?



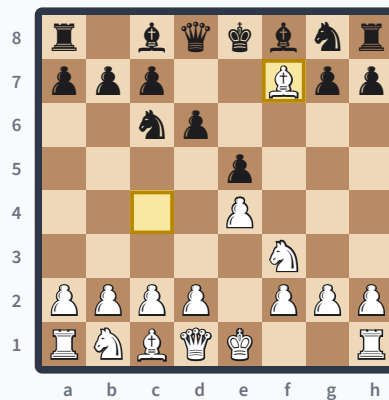
Answer: _____

4 White just moved (yellow squares). Write down the move.



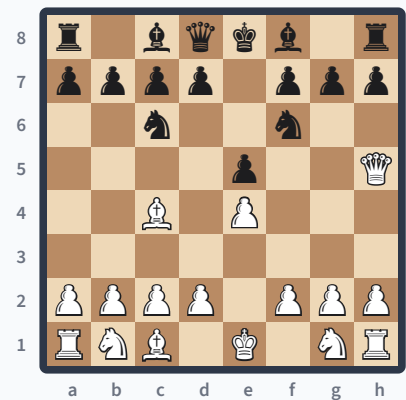
Answer: _____

5 White captured with check (yellow squares). Write the move with x and +.



Answer: _____

6 1.e4 e5 2.Qh5 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6??
What is White's winning 4th move?



Answer: _____

Tip: letter first, then number. Use the labels on the edge of each board to help.

Score: ____ / 6

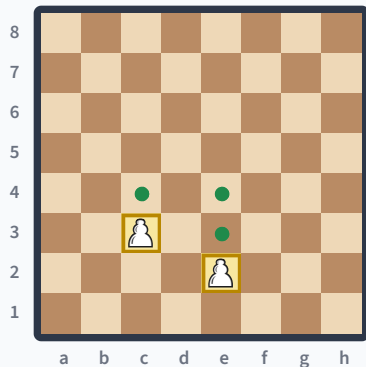
THE PAWN

Small but brave • It can become a Queen!

Lesson 3 • Basics
Beginner Handouts

1. Straight Forward

1 STEP (2 AT THE START)

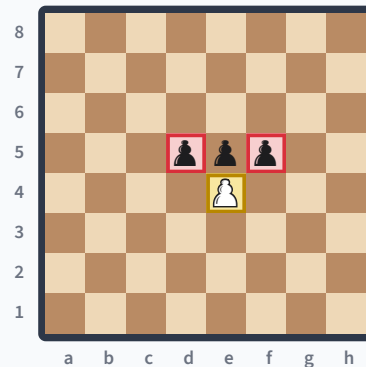


e2: to e3 or e4 • c3: to c4 only

- A pawn moves **straight forward one square**. It can never go backwards.
- On its **very first move** it may jump two squares (e2–e4).

2. Captures Diagonally

EXD5 OR EXF5

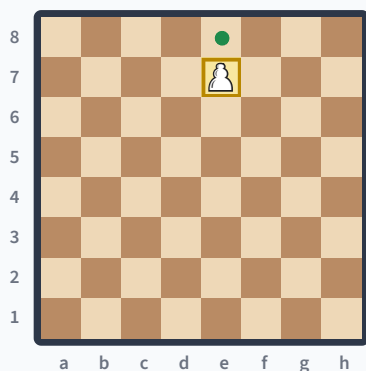


e4 can take d5 or f5, not e5

- Pawns capture **one square diagonally forward**, a different way from how they move.
- A piece straight in front **blocks** the pawn: it can't move or capture straight ahead.

3. Promotion

LAST ROW = NEW PIECE

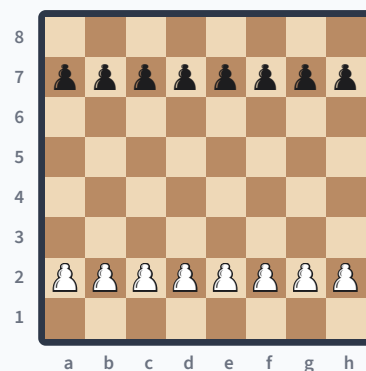


e7–e8 = a brand-new Queen!

- A pawn that reaches the **last row** must turn into a Queen, Rook, Bishop or Knight.
- Almost always choose the **Queen**, the strongest piece (more in Lesson 10).

4. Game: The Pawn Game

8 PAWNS VS 8 PAWNS



Only pawns. White moves first.

- All the normal pawn rules apply, including the two-square first move.
- Rules for winning are in the box below.

Pawn Game Rules

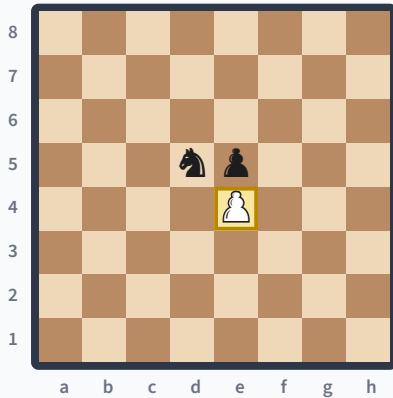
1. **To win:** get one pawn to the other side, OR capture all of your opponent's pawns.
2. **Next game:** the loser plays White (moves first) and removes one of the winner's pawns before starting.
3. **Tip:** pawns side by side protect each other. A pawn with no enemy pawns in front of it is a runner!

PUZZLES: THE PAWN

Moves, captures, races and promotion

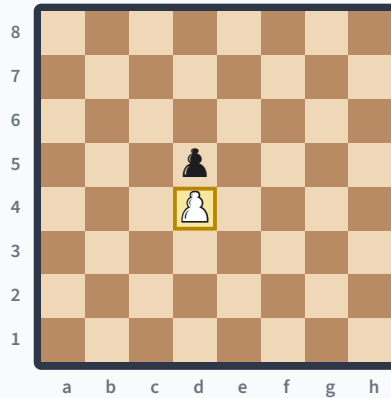
Lesson 3 · Basics Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

- 1** Which capture can the White pawn make? Write it down.



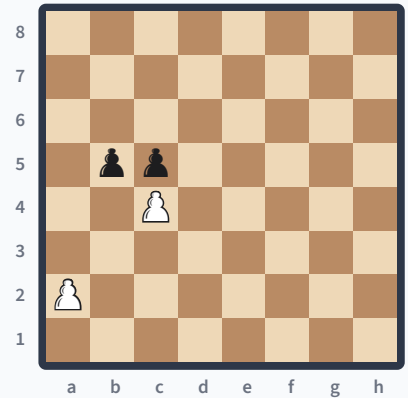
Answer: _____

- 2** Can the White pawn move? Why or why not?



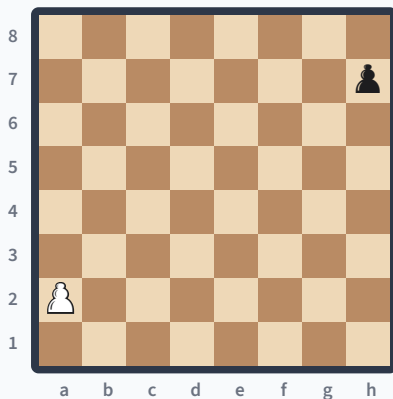
Answer: _____

- 3** How many different moves can the White pawns make? List them.



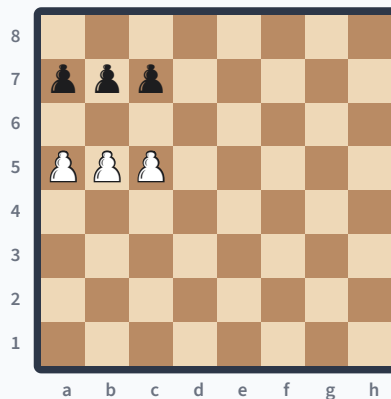
Answer: _____

- 4** Pawn race! White to move. Who promotes first?



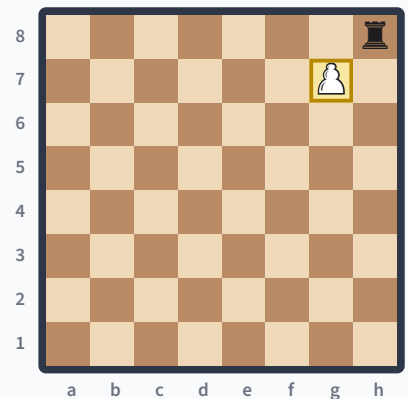
Answer: _____

- 5** Pawn Game: White to move and WIN!



Answer: _____

- 6** White to move. What is the best promotion? Write the move.



Answer: _____

Tip: White pawns move UP the board, Black pawns move DOWN. Count moves carefully!

Score: ____ / 6

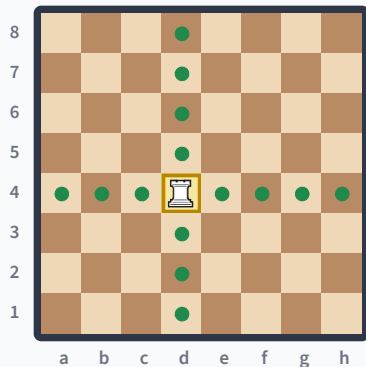
THE ROOK

The castle tower • Straight lines, as far as it likes

Lesson 4 • Basics
Beginner Handouts

1. Straight Lines

UP, DOWN, LEFT, RIGHT

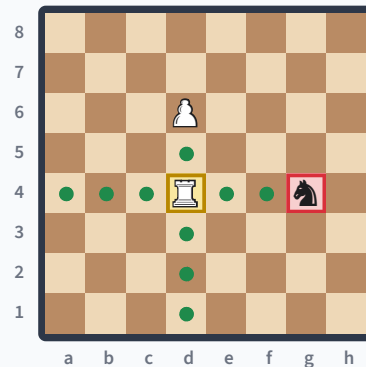


Rook on d4: 14 squares to go

- The Rook moves along its **rank** (row) or its **file** (column), as many squares as it wants.
- It never moves diagonally.

2. Blocked & Captures

RXG4

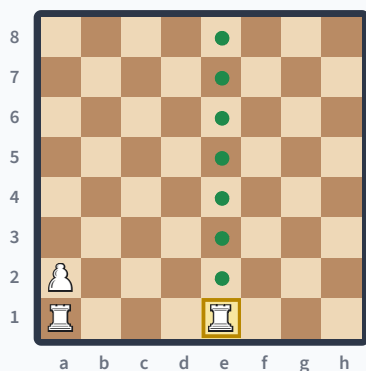


Own pawn on d6 • enemy Knight on g4

- Rooks **can't jump**. Your own pawn on d6 blocks the way up.
- To capture, land on the enemy's square (**Rxg4**). The Rook can't go past it.

3. Rooks Love Open Files

NO PAWNS IN THE WAY

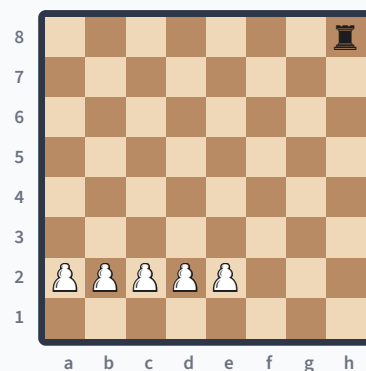


e1-Rook: the whole e-file

- The **a1**-Rook is stuck behind its own a2-pawn: it can't go up at all.
- The **e1**-Rook sits on an **open file** and can reach all the way to e8.

4. Game: Rook vs. 5 Pawns

CATCH THEM ALL



Pawns a2-e2 • Rook h8

- The pawns (White) move first. No Kings in this game.
- Play twice and swap sides: who is better, the Rook or the pawns?

Rook vs. 5 Pawns: Rules & Tips

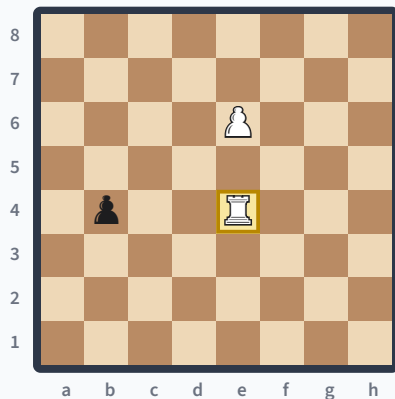
1. **To win:** the Rook must capture all 5 pawns. The pawns win if one of them reaches the last row (or if a pawn captures the Rook!).
2. **Rook tip:** attack pawns from behind or from the side, and only take a pawn that isn't protected.
3. **Pawn tip:** march side by side so every pawn is protected. A lonely pawn is an easy snack.

PUZZLES: THE ROOK

Straight lines, free pieces and the ladder

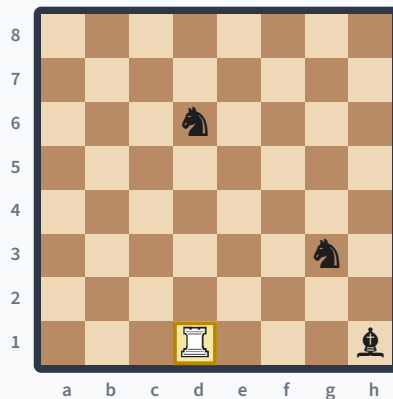
Lesson 4 · Basics Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

- 1** How many squares can the Rook move to? Count captures too.



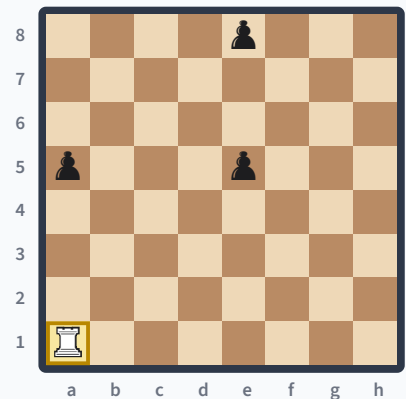
Answer: _____

- 2** White to move. Which Black piece can the Rook capture for free?



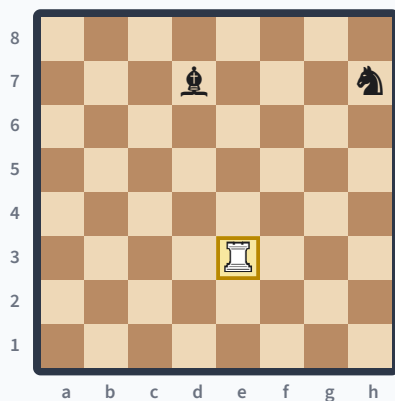
Answer: _____

- 3** Black stays still. How many Rook moves to take all 3 pawns?



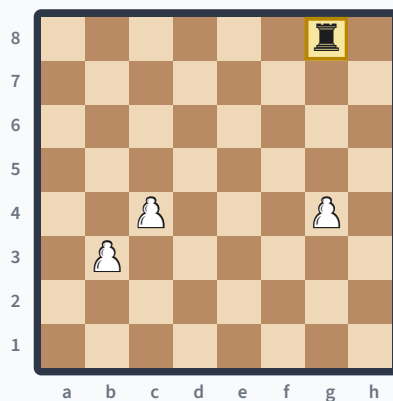
Answer: _____

- 4** White to move. Find the Rook move that attacks BOTH Black pieces.



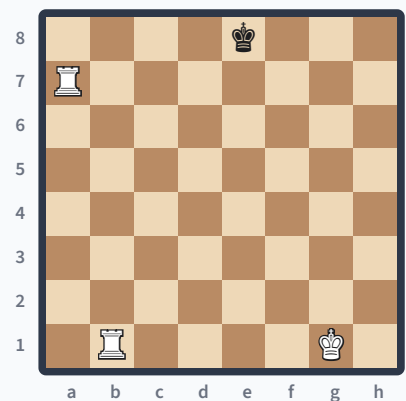
Answer: _____

- 5** Black to move. Which pawn can the Rook take safely?



Answer: _____

- 6** White to move. Checkmate in 1 with the ladder!



Answer: _____

Tip: before you take, check if the piece is defended. A Rook (5) for a Knight (3) is a bad trade!

Score: ____ / 6

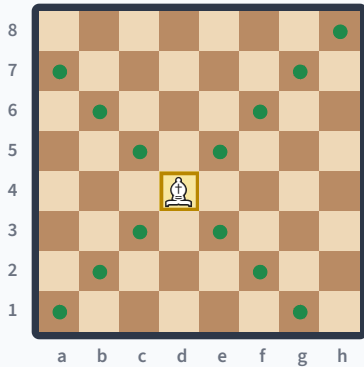
THE BISHOP

Diagonals only • It stays on one colour forever

Lesson 5 • Basics
Beginner Handouts

1. Diagonal Lines

4 DIRECTIONS

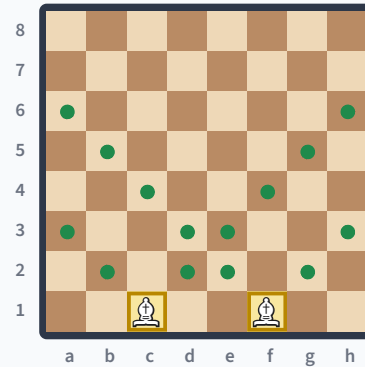


Bishop on d4: 13 squares to go

- The Bishop moves **diagonally**, as many squares as it wants.
- It never moves straight up, down or sideways.

2. Light & Dark Bishops

ONE OF EACH

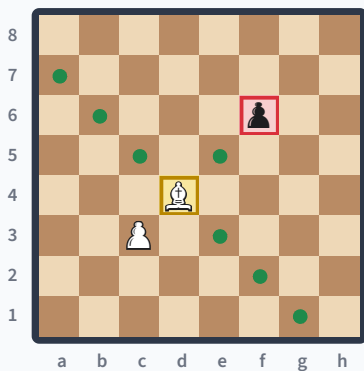


c1 = dark squares • f1 = light squares

- Each side starts with one **dark-squared** and one **light-squared** Bishop.
- A Bishop keeps its colour **all game**, so it can only ever reach half the board.

3. Blocked & Captures

BXF6

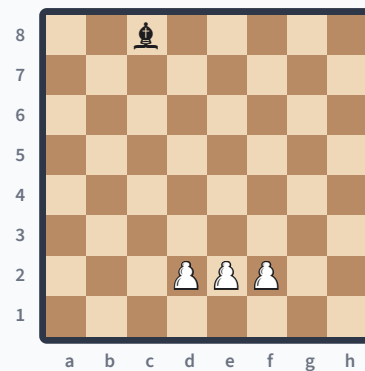


Own pawn on c3 • enemy pawn on f6

- Like the Rook, the Bishop **can't jump**. The c3-pawn blocks one whole diagonal.
- It captures by landing on the enemy's square: **Bxf6**.

4. Game: Bishop vs. 3 Pawns

CATCH THEM ALL



Pawns d2, e2, f2 • Bishop c8

- The pawns (White) move first. No Kings in this game.
- Play twice and swap sides.

Bishop vs. 3 Pawns: Rules & Tips

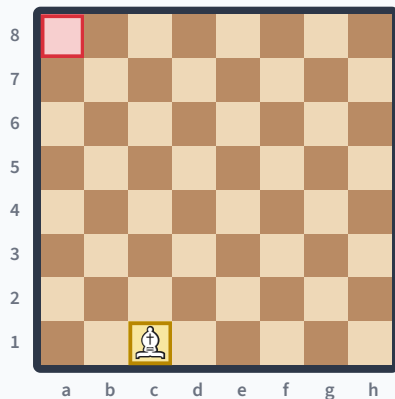
1. **To win:** the Bishop must capture all 3 pawns. The pawns win if one reaches the last row (or captures the Bishop).
2. **Pawn tip:** the c8-Bishop only sees **light** squares. A pawn standing on a **dark** square is completely safe from it!
3. **Bishop tip:** get in front of the pawns early and guard the light squares they must cross.

PUZZLES: THE BISHOP

Diagonals, colours and double attacks

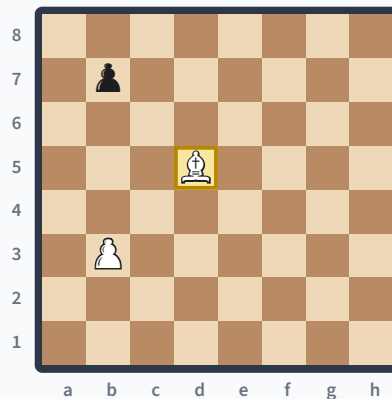
Lesson 5 · Basics Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

- 1** The Bishop is on c1. Can it EVER reach a8? Why?



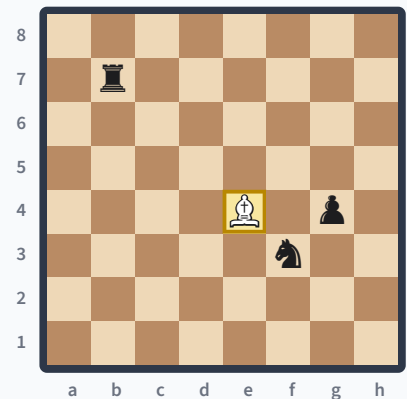
Answer: _____

- 2** How many squares can the Bishop move to? Count captures too.



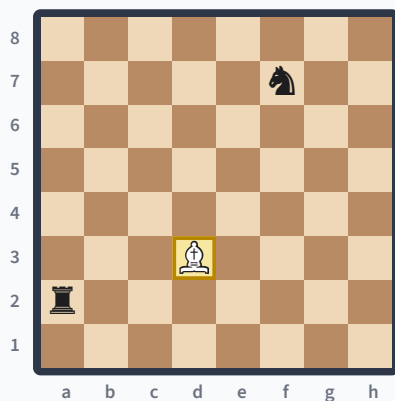
Answer: _____

- 3** White to move. Which Black piece can the Bishop take for free?



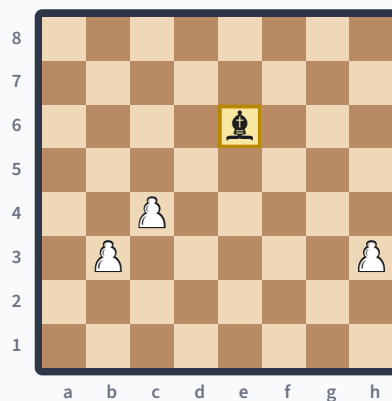
Answer: _____

- 4** White to move. Find the Bishop move that attacks BOTH Black pieces.



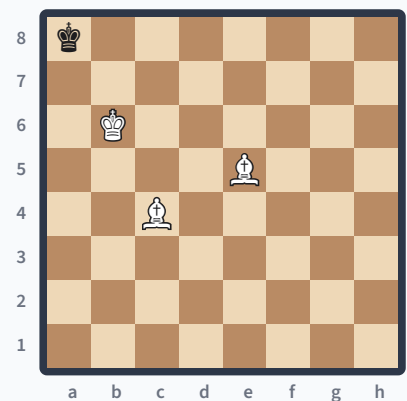
Answer: _____

- 5** Black to move. Which pawn can the Bishop take safely?



Answer: _____

- 6** White to move. Checkmate in 1 with the two Bishops!



Answer: _____

Tip: trace each diagonal with your finger until it hits the edge or a piece.

Score: ____ / 6

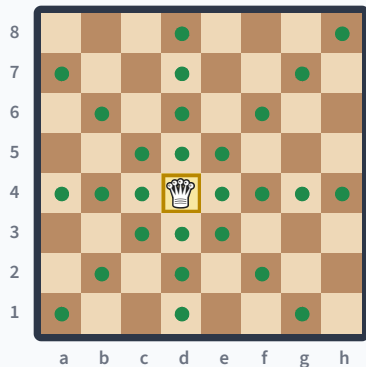
THE QUEEN

The strongest piece • A Rook and a Bishop in one

Lesson 6 • Basics
Beginner Handouts

1. Every Direction

ROOK + BISHOP

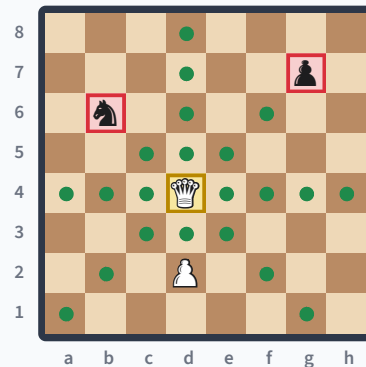


Queen on d4: 27 squares to go!

- The Queen moves in **straight lines** (like a Rook) AND on **diagonals** (like a Bishop).
- As many squares as she wants, in any one direction per move.

2. Blocked & Captures

QXB6 OR QXG7



Own pawn d2 • enemies on b6 and g7

- The Queen **can't jump** either: her own d2-pawn blocks the way down.
- She can capture the Knight on **b6** or the pawn on **g7**.

3. Don't Bring Her Out Too Early

WORTH 9 POINTS

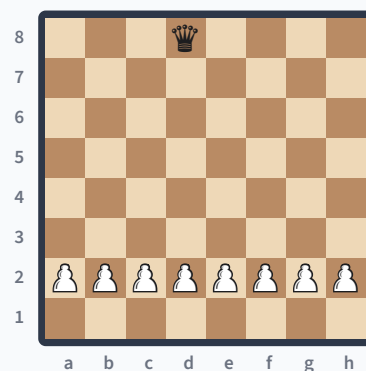


1.e4 e5 2.Bc4 Nc6 3.Qh5 g6!

- Because she's so valuable, the Queen **must run away** whenever she is attacked.
- Here a little pawn chases her, and she wastes time while Black develops.

4. Game: Queen vs. 8 Pawns

CATCH THEM ALL



8 pawns on rank 2 • Queen d8

- The pawns (White) move first. No Kings in this game.
- Play twice and swap sides.

Queen vs. 8 Pawns: Rules & Tips

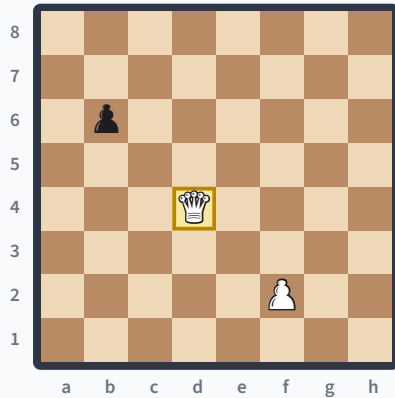
- To win:** the Queen must capture all 8 pawns. The pawns win if one reaches the last row (or captures the Queen).
- Queen tip:** attack two loose pawns at once (a fork!). Never take a pawn that another pawn protects.
- Pawn tip:** move in pairs so each pawn is protected. A protected pawn can't be taken without losing the Queen.

PUZZLES: THE QUEEN

Power, forks and first checkmates

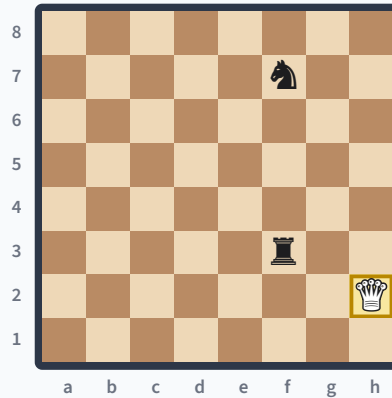
Lesson 6 · Basics Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

- 1** How many squares can the Queen move to? Count captures too.



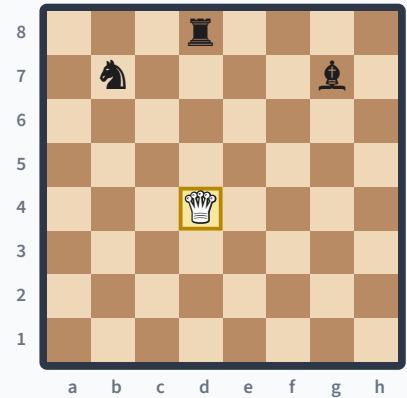
Answer: _____

- 2** White to move. Find the Queen move that attacks BOTH Black pieces.



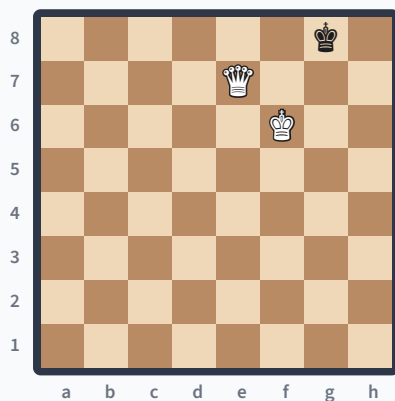
Answer: _____

- 3** White to move. Which Black piece can the Queen take for free?



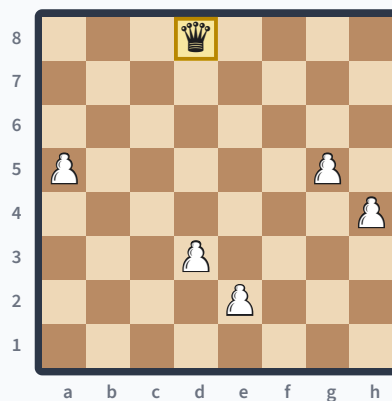
Answer: _____

- 4** White to move. Checkmate in 1!



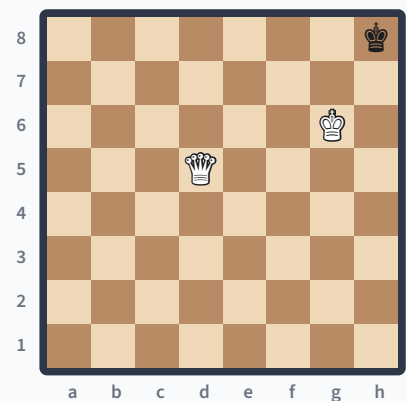
Answer: _____

- 5** Black to move. Which pawn can the Queen take safely?



Answer: _____

- 6** Find TWO different mates in 1. Careful: some moves are stalemate!



Answer: _____

Tip: the Queen is worth 9. Never trade her for something defended and cheaper!

Score: ____ / 6

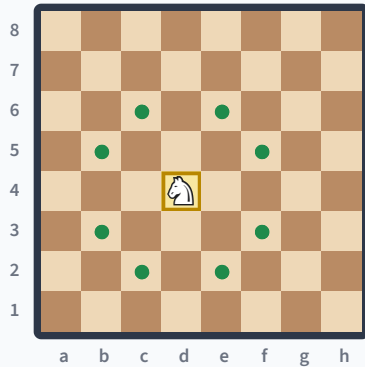
THE KNIGHT

The horse • Moves in an L and jumps over pieces

Lesson 7 • Basics
Beginner Handouts

1. The L-Shape

2 ONE WAY, 1 TO THE SIDE

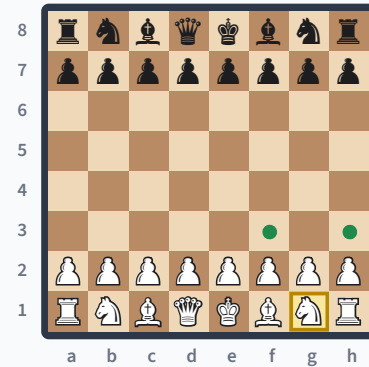


Knight on d4: 8 squares

- Two squares in a straight line, then one square to the side: an **L**.
- It lands only on the end of the L, and captures a piece standing there.

2. The Only Jumper

OVER THE PAWNS

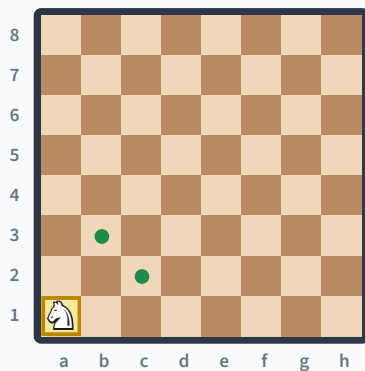


From the start: Nf3 or Nh3

- The Knight is the **only piece that can jump** over other pieces, even its own.
- That's why it can move before any pawn has moved. Nf3 is a great first move!

3. Knight on the Rim Is Dim

CORNER = 2 MOVES

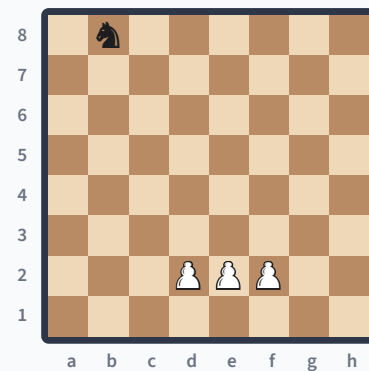


Knight on a1: only b3 and c2

- In the corner a Knight has just **2** moves. In the centre it has **8**. Keep Knights central!
- Fun fact: a Knight always lands on the **opposite colour** to the one it started on.

4. Game: Knight vs. 3 Pawns

CATCH THEM ALL



Pawns d2, e2, f2 • Knight b8

- The pawns (White) move first. No Kings in this game.
- Play twice and swap sides.

Knight vs. 3 Pawns: Rules & Tips

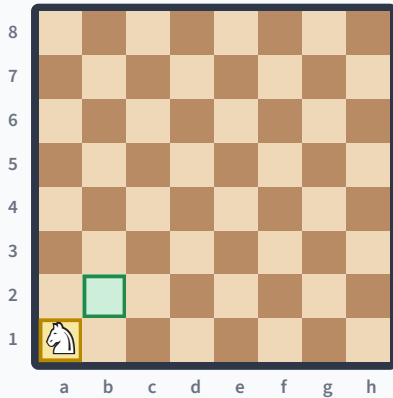
1. **To win:** the Knight must capture all 3 pawns. The pawns win if one reaches the last row (or captures the Knight).
2. **Knight tip:** look for a square that attacks **two** pawns at once: that's a fork!
3. **Pawn tip:** Knights are slow over long distances. Push the pawn that is furthest from the Knight.

PUZZLES: THE KNIGHT

L-shapes, long journeys and forks

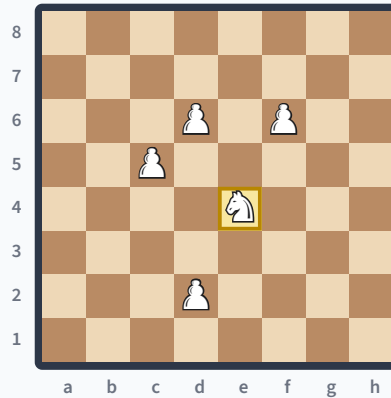
Lesson 7 · Basics Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

- 1** Knight a1 to b2, right next door. Fewest moves?



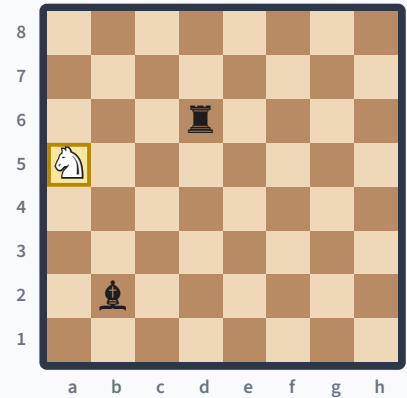
Answer: _____

- 2** How many squares can the White Knight move to?



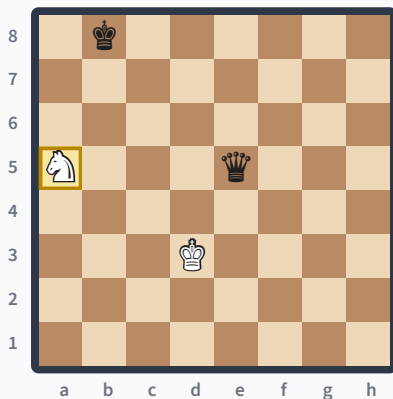
Answer: _____

- 3** White to move. Find the Knight move that attacks BOTH Black pieces.



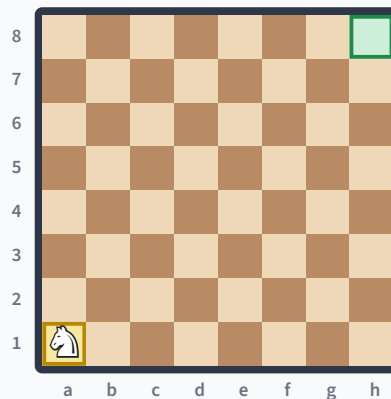
Answer: _____

- 4** Royal Fork! Check the King AND attack the Queen.



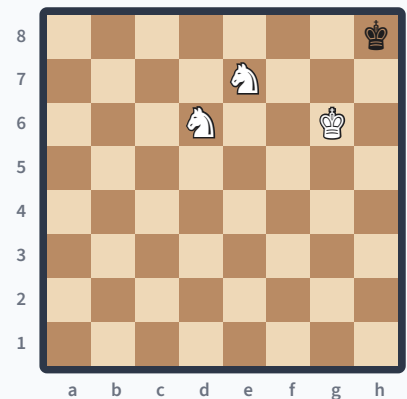
Answer: _____

- 5** Knight a1 to h8, the far corner. Fewest moves?



Answer: _____

- 6** White to move. Checkmate in 1 with a Knight!



Answer: _____

Tip: a Knight always lands on the opposite colour. Squares next door can be a long way away!

Score: ____ / 6

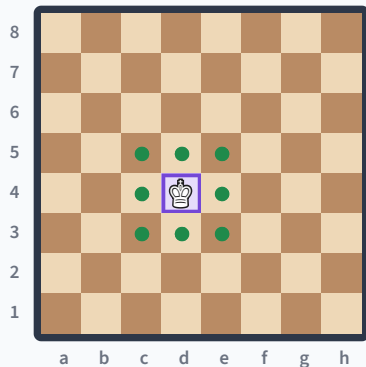
THE KING

Check, checkmate and stalemate

Lesson 8 · Basics
Beginner Handouts

1. One Step at a Time

ANY DIRECTION

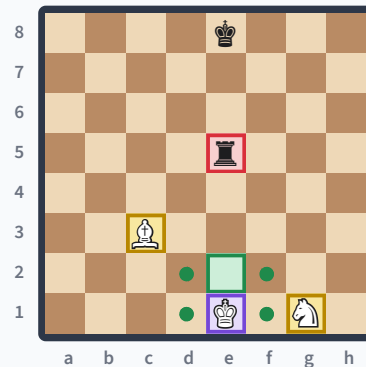


King on d4: 8 squares

- The King moves **one square** in any direction.
- It may **never** step onto a square that is attacked, so two Kings can never stand side by side.

2. Check: 3 Ways Out

MOVE · CAPTURE · BLOCK

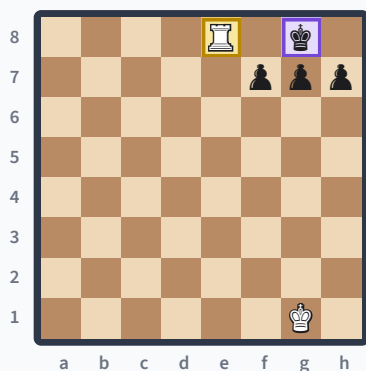


Kd1 · Bxe5 · Ne2

- The Rook on e5 attacks the King: that's **check**. You **MUST** get out of it at once.
- Move** the King (dots), **capture** the attacker (Bxe5), or **block** the line (Ne2).

3. Checkmate

NO WAY OUT = YOU WIN

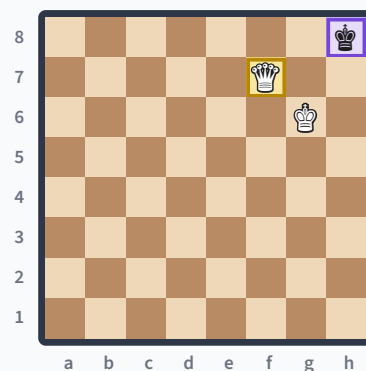


Re8#

- In check, and **no way** to move, capture or block: that's **checkmate**. Game over!
- Here Black's own pawns trap the King on the back row.

4. Stalemate

NO MOVES, NO CHECK = DRAW



Black to move: stalemate

- Black is **not** in check, but every square around the King is attacked, and it has no other piece to move.
- That's **stalemate**: a **DRAW**, even though White has a whole Queen extra!

Check, Checkmate or Stalemate?

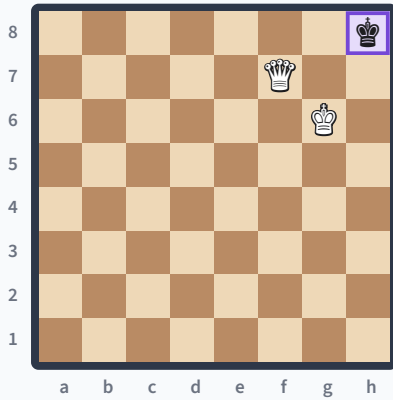
	Is the King attacked?	Any legal move?	Result
Check	Yes	Yes	Get out of check, keep playing
Checkmate	Yes	No	The attacker WINS
Stalemate	No	No	DRAW

PUZZLES: THE KING

Check, checkmate or stalemate?

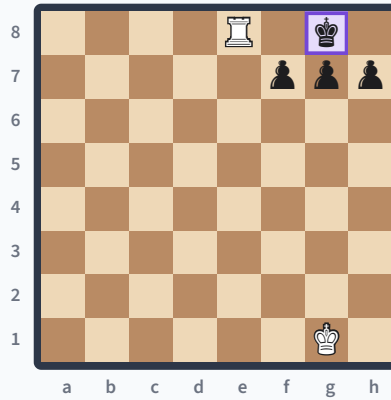
Lesson 8 · Basics Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

1 Black to move. Check, checkmate or stalemate?



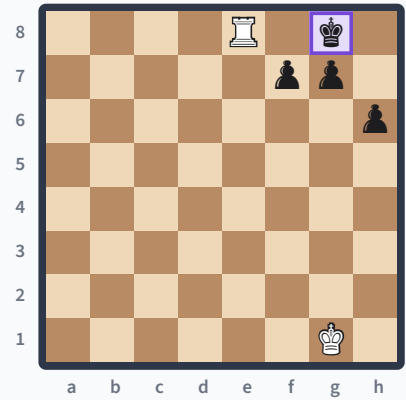
Answer: _____

2 Black to move. Check, checkmate or stalemate?



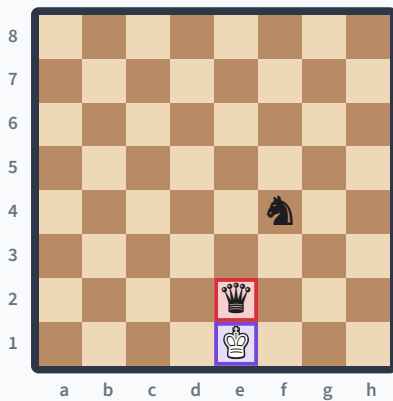
Answer: _____

3 Black to move. Check, checkmate or stalemate?



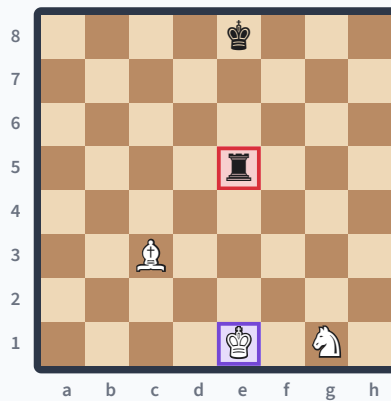
Answer: _____

4 White to move. Can the King take the Queen? What is this?



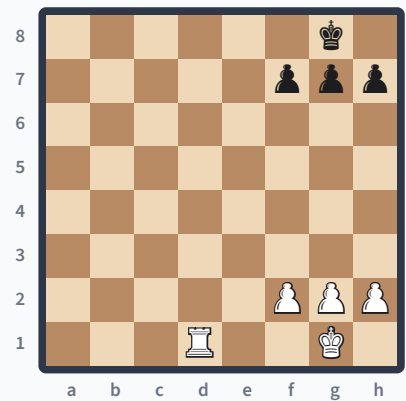
Answer: _____

5 White is in check. List ALL the ways out (there are 6!).



Answer: _____

6 White to move. Checkmate in 1!



Answer: _____

Tip: ask two questions. Is the King attacked? Does the side to move have ANY legal move?

Score: ____ / 6

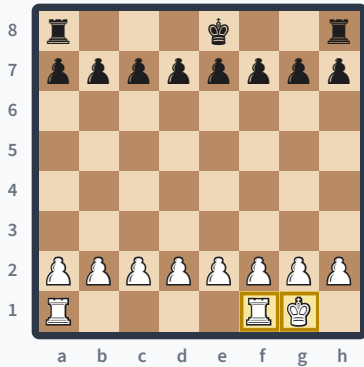
CASTLING

The only move with two pieces • King safe, Rook in play

Lesson 9 • Basics
Beginner Handouts

1. Kingside Castling

O-O (SHORT)

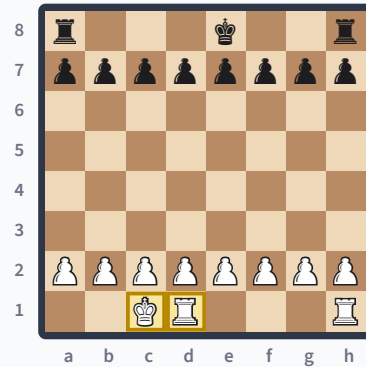


King e1→g1 • Rook h1→f1

- The King moves **two squares** toward the Rook. The Rook jumps over to the King's other side.
- Touch the King first. Castling counts as one move.

2. Queenside Castling

O-O-O (LONG)

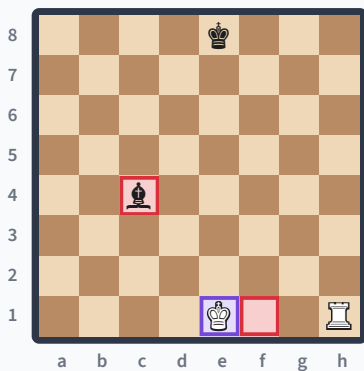


King e1→c1 • Rook a1→d1

- Same idea on the other side: the King still moves **two squares**, the Rook lands next to it on d1.
- Here b1, c1 and d1 must all be empty first.

3. Not Through Check

F1 IS ATTACKED

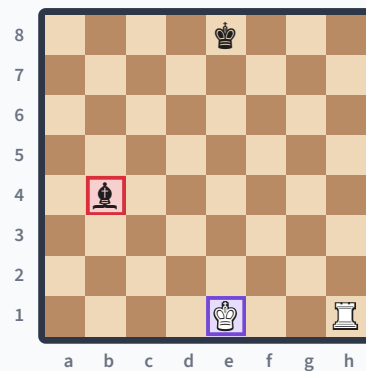


O-O is NOT allowed here

- The Black Bishop attacks **f1**, the square the King must cross. No castling!
- The King also may not **land** on an attacked square.

4. Not Out of Check

KING IN CHECK



O-O is NOT allowed here either

- The Bishop on b4 gives check. You can't castle to escape a check.
- And never if the King (or that Rook) has **already moved**, even if it went back home.

Castling Checklist: All 5 Must Be Yes

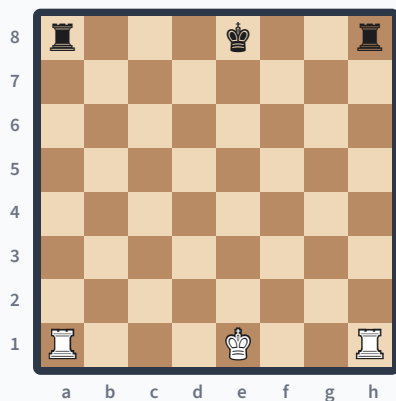
1. The King has **never moved**.
2. That Rook has **never moved**.
3. All squares **between** them are empty.
4. The King is **not in check** right now.
5. The King doesn't **cross or land on** an attacked square.

PUZZLES: CASTLING

In every puzzle, the King and Rooks have not moved yet

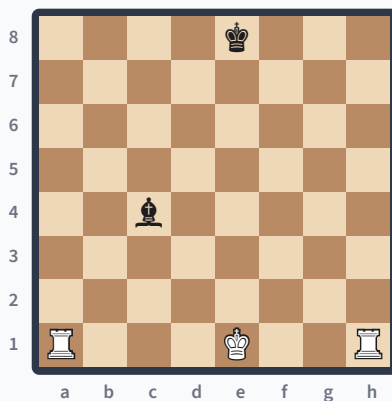
Lesson 9 · Basics Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

- 1** Can White castle? Which side: kingside, queenside, both or neither?



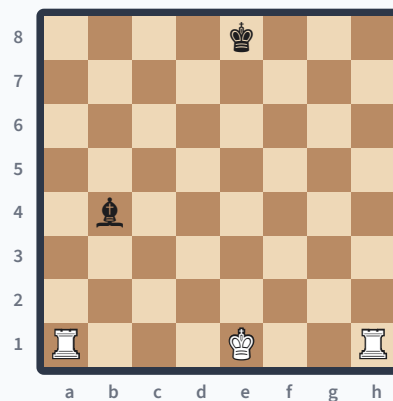
Answer: _____

- 2** Can White castle? Which side: kingside, queenside, both or neither?



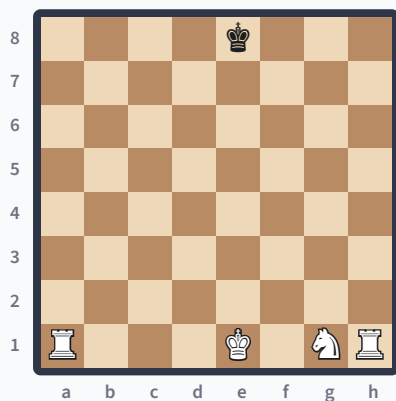
Answer: _____

- 3** Can White castle? Which side: kingside, queenside, both or neither?



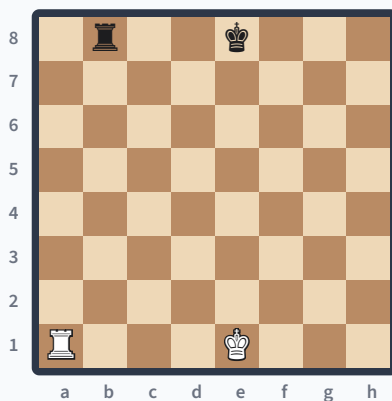
Answer: _____

- 4** Can White castle? Which side: kingside, queenside, both or neither?



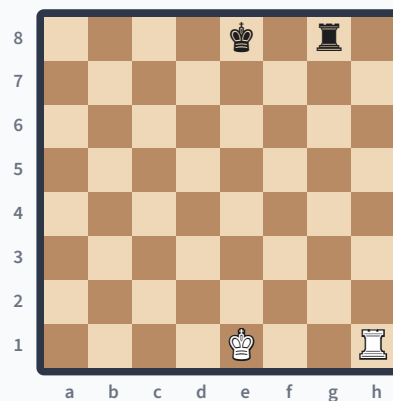
Answer: _____

- 5** Can White castle? Which side: kingside, queenside, both or neither?



Answer: _____

- 6** Can White castle? Which side: kingside, queenside, both or neither?



Answer: _____

Tip: check the squares the KING crosses and lands on. The Rook is allowed to cross an attacked square!

Score: ____ / 6

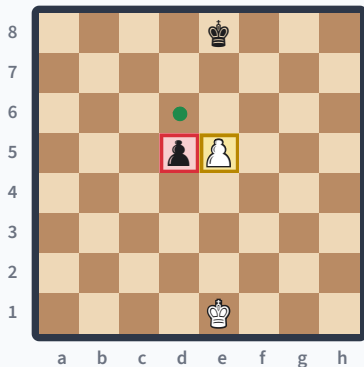
EN PASSANT & PROMOTION

Lesson 10 · Basics
Beginner Handouts

Two special pawn rules every player must know

1. En Passant: The Set-Up

"IN PASSING"

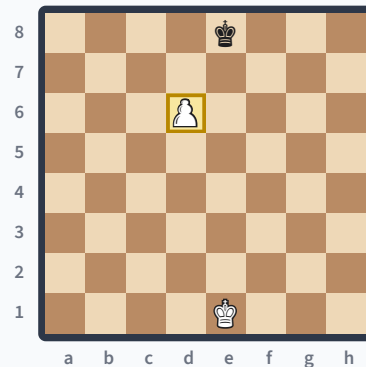


Black just played d7-d5

- Black's pawn jumped two squares and landed **right beside** White's pawn on e5.
- White may capture it **as if it had moved only one square**, landing on d6.

2. En Passant: The Capture

EXD6 E.P.

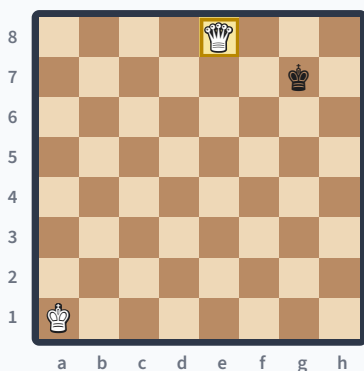


After 2.exd6 e.p.

- White's pawn moves to **d6** and Black's d5-pawn is taken off the board.
- Only allowed on the **very next move**. Wait one turn and the chance is gone.

3. Promotion

E8=Q

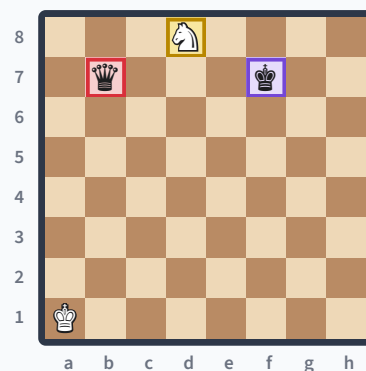


After 1.e8=Q

- A pawn on the last row is swapped for a **Queen, Rook, Bishop or Knight** (never a King).
- You can have two Queens or more! No spare Queen? Use an upside-down Rook.

4. Underpromotion

D8=N+! FORK



After 1.d8=N+! (then 2.Nxb7)

- Sometimes a **Knight** beats a Queen: here it gives check AND attacks the Queen on b7.
- Promoting to a Rook or Bishop can also avoid stalemate. Always check first!

Special Pawn Rules in a Nutshell

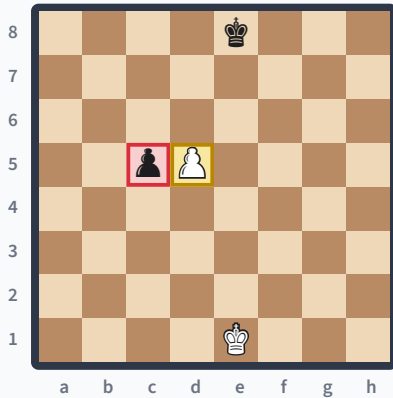
1. **En passant:** only a pawn can do it, only against a pawn that just jumped two squares past it, and only right away.
2. **Promotion:** any pawn reaching the last row **MUST** become a Queen, Rook, Bishop or Knight, your choice.
3. **Underpromotion:** choose a Knight for a fork or check, a Rook or Bishop to avoid stalemate.

PUZZLES: SPECIAL MOVES

En passant and promotion in action

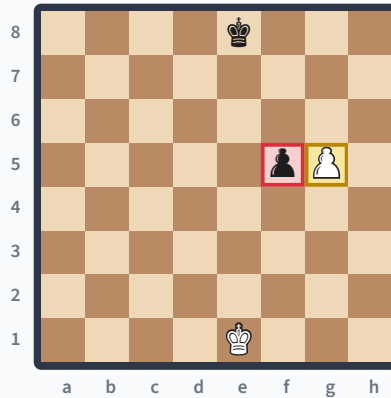
Lesson 10 · Basics Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

- 1** Black just played c7–c5. Write White's en passant capture.



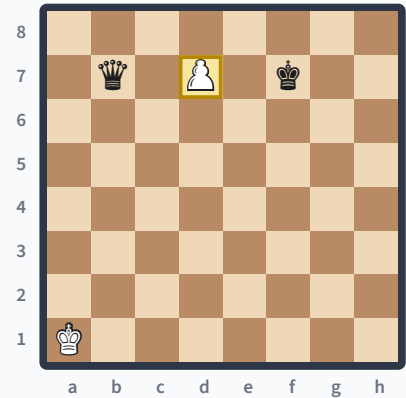
Answer: _____

- 2** Black's last move was f6–f5 (one step). Can White take en passant?



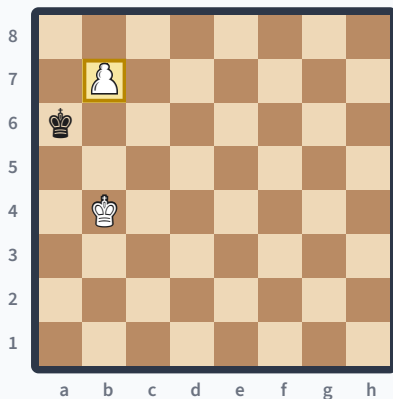
Answer: _____

- 3** White to move. Promote with a FORK! Which piece?



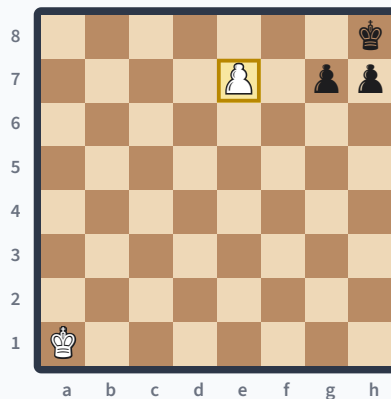
Answer: _____

- 4** White to move. Promote, but DON'T stalemate! Which piece?



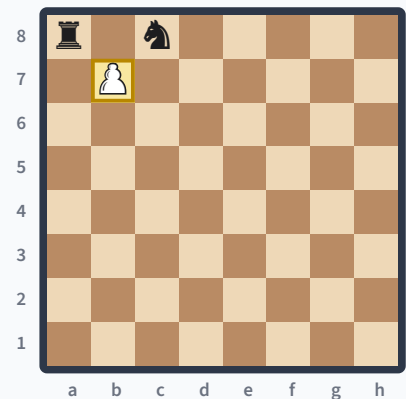
Answer: _____

- 5** White to move. Promote and checkmate in 1!



Answer: _____

- 6** White to move. Which promotion wins the most?



Answer: _____

Tip: before promoting, check: will my new piece give stalemate? Could a Knight fork?

Score: ____ / 6

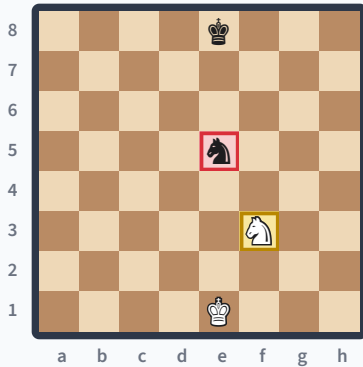
IS IT SAFE?

Hanging pieces, counting and fair trades

Lesson 11 · Defence
Beginner Handouts

1. Hanging Pieces

FREE TO TAKE

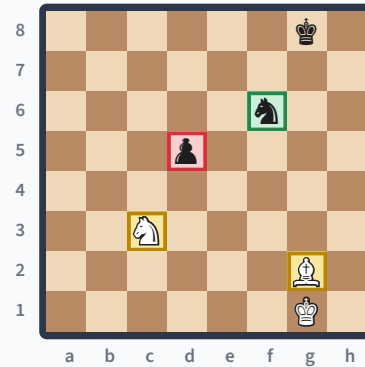


1.Nxe5: a free Knight!

- A piece that is attacked and **not defended** is "hanging". Take it!
- Before every move, also check: are any of **my** pieces hanging?

2. Count: 2 Attackers vs. 1

TAKE IT

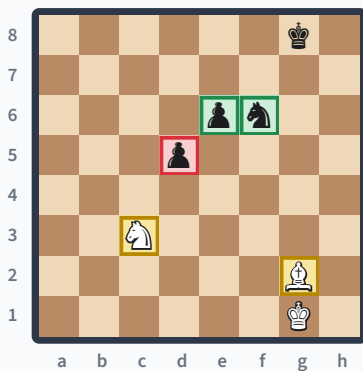


1.Nxd5 Nxd5 2.Bxd5

- Attackers on d5: **Nc3 + Bg2 = 2**. Defenders: **Nf6 = 1**.
- More attackers than defenders: the pieces swap off and White wins the pawn.

3. Count: 2 Attackers vs. 2

DON'T TAKE

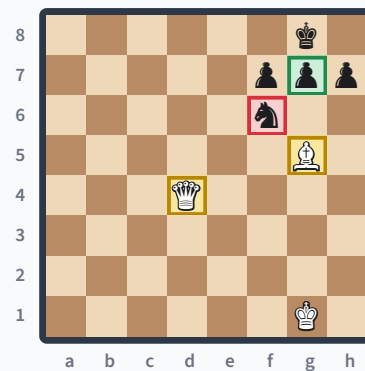


1.Nxd5? exd5 2.Bxd5 Nxd5

- Now d5 has **2 defenders** (e6-pawn + Nf6). The swap ends with Black taking last.
- White gives a Knight and a Bishop (6 points) for two pawns (2 points). Bad deal!

4. Cheapest Piece First

BXF6, NOT QXF6



Bxf6 = fair · Qxf6?? = bad

- **Bxf6 gxf6**: Bishop (3) for Knight (3), a fair trade.
- **Qxf6?? gxf6**: Queen (9) for Knight (3). Always capture a defended piece with your **cheapest** piece.

Before You Capture, Ask:

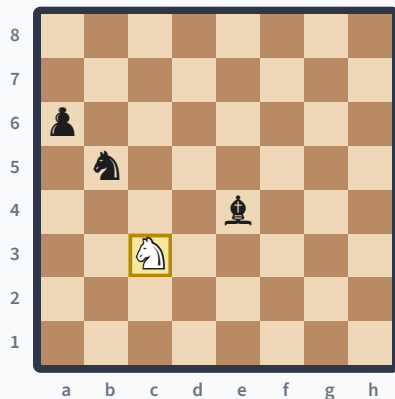
1. **Is it defended?** No defenders? It's hanging; take it (after checking it's not a trap!).
2. **Count** attackers vs. defenders. More attackers usually wins it; equal or fewer usually doesn't.
3. **Add up the points** you give and get: Pawn 1 · Knight 3 · Bishop 3 · Rook 5 · Queen 9.

PUZZLES: IS IT SAFE?

Free pieces, counting and fair trades

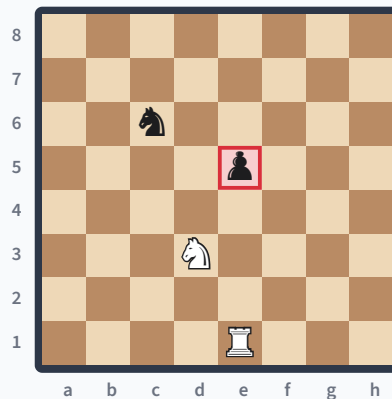
Lesson 11 · Defence Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

- 1** White to move. Which Black piece can the Knight take for free?



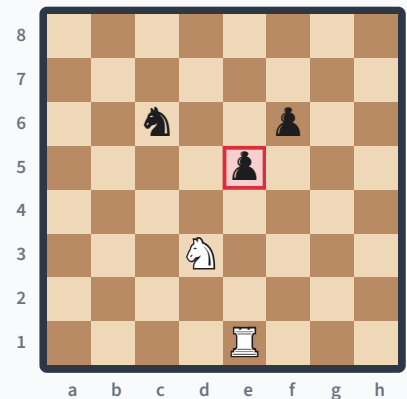
Answer: _____

- 2** White to move. Can White win the e5-pawn? Count!



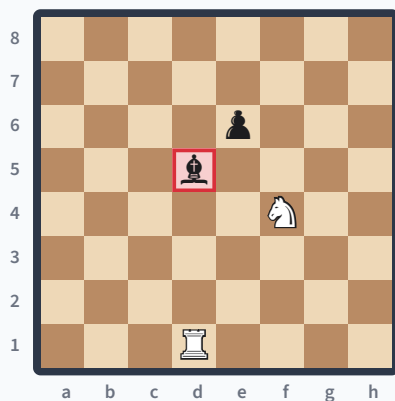
Answer: _____

- 3** White to move. NOW can White win the e5-pawn? Count again!



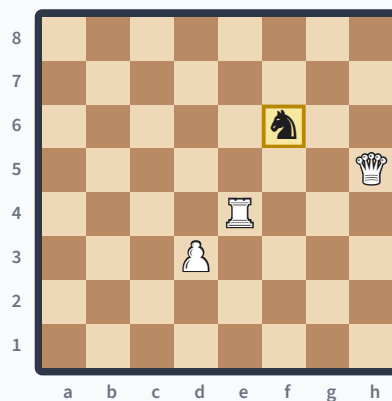
Answer: _____

- 4** White to move. Take the d5-Bishop: with the Knight or the Rook?



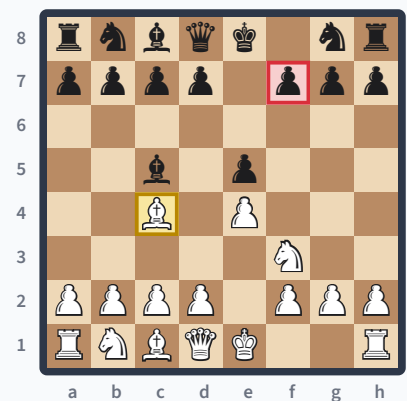
Answer: _____

- 5** Black to move. What can the Black Knight take for free?



Answer: _____

- 6** White to move. Is 4.Bxf7+ a good idea? Count!



Answer: _____

Tip: Pawn 1 · Knight 3 · Bishop 3 · Rook 5 · Queen 9. Count what you give and what you get!

Score: ____ / 6

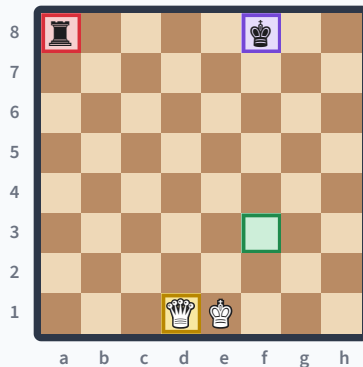
CHECKS, CAPTURES, THREATS

The three questions to ask before every move

Lesson 12 · Defence
Beginner Handouts

1. Checks

LOOK AT EVERY CHECK

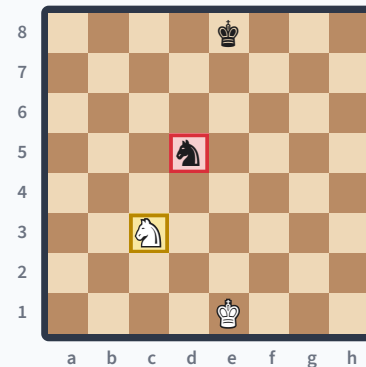


1.Qf3+! and next 2.Qxa8

- List **every check** you can give. Most do nothing, but one might win something!
- **1.Qf3+** checks the King AND attacks the Rook. The King must move, then take the Rook.

2. Captures

IS IT FREE?

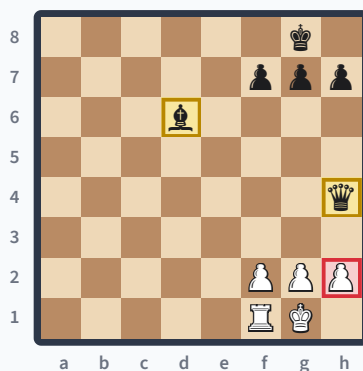


1.Nxd5: nothing guards d5

- List **every capture**. Then ask: is the piece guarded?
- Nothing guards the d5-Knight, so it is **free**. Take it!

3. Threats

WHAT DO THEY WANT?

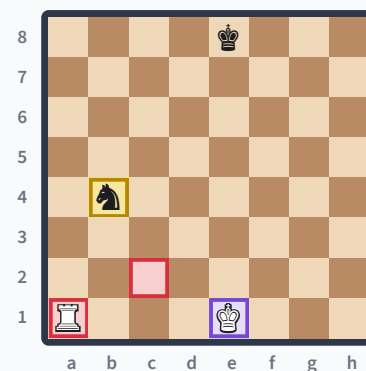


Black threatens ...Qxh2#!

- Before your own plan, ask: **what is my opponent trying to do?**
- Here Black wants ...Qxh2#. Stop it with **1.g3** or **1.h3**.

4. Their CCT Too

THINK LIKE THEM



Stop ...Nc2+: 1.Rb1 or 1.Kd2

- Do CCT for your opponent: their **checks, captures** and **threats**.
- Black wants ...Nc2+, forking King and Rook. Move the Rook, or guard c2 with the King.

The CCT Routine

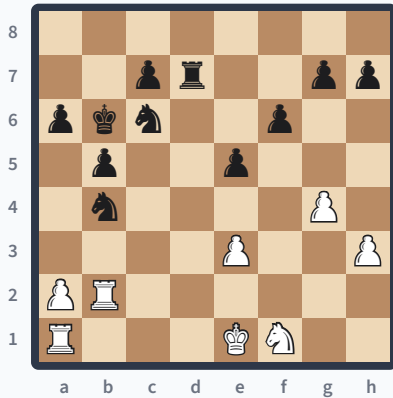
1. **Checks:** list every check, for you AND for your opponent.
2. **Captures:** list every capture. Is it free? Count attackers and defenders.
3. **Threats:** what does my opponent want to do next? Stop it first, then carry on with your plan.

PUZZLES: CCT

Checks, Captures, Threats · six positions from real Lichess games

Lesson 12 · Defence Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

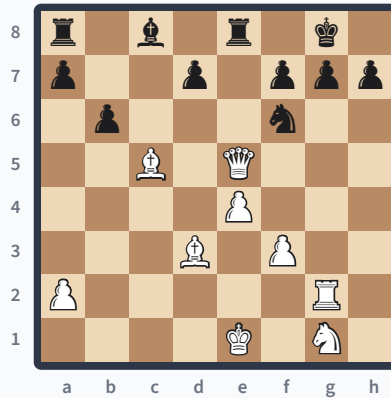
- 1** Black to move. Look at every check. Which one wins?



White (1289) v Black (1701) · 7+9
lichess.org/CT49XZGj

Answer: _____

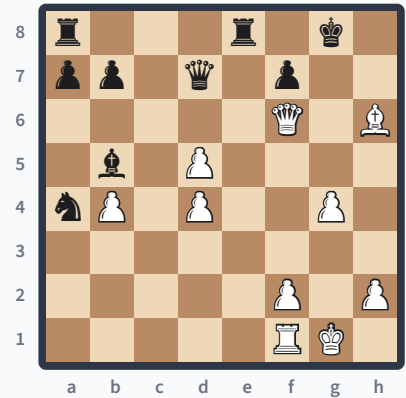
- 2** Black to move. Is anything free to take?



White (1307) v Black (1631) · 10+0
lichess.org/6gcZ6qX7

Answer: _____

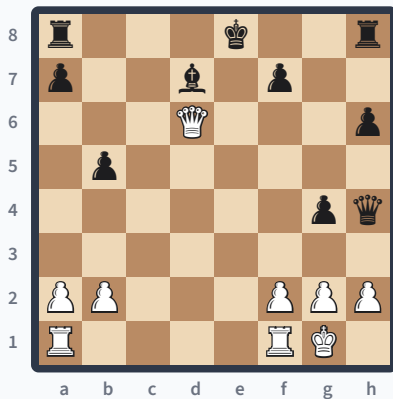
- 3** Black to move. What does your opponent threaten? Stop it!



White (1169) v Black (1104) · 10+0
lichess.org/ZKQAL78x

Answer: _____

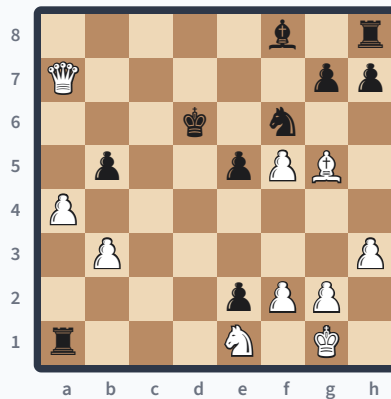
- 4** White to move. Look at every check. Which one wins?



White (1662) v Black (1849) · 10+0
lichess.org/nLLl4gtH

Answer: _____

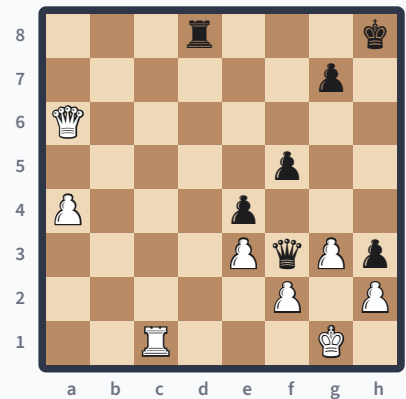
- 5** Black to move. Is anything free to take?



White (1114) v Black (1384) · 10+0
lichess.org/R2Vnrli7

Answer: _____

- 6** White to move. What does your opponent threaten? Stop it!



White (1733) v Black (1672) · 5+5
lichess.org/VzLpYJ1R

Answer: _____

Tip: go through the list every time: checks, captures, threats. For you AND your opponent.

Score: ____ / 6

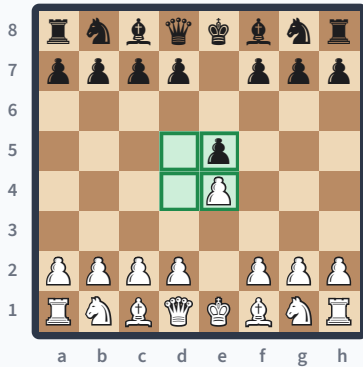
OPENING BASICS

Centre, develop, castle • How to start every game

Lesson 13 • Openings
Beginner Handouts

1. Control the Centre

D4 E4 D5 E5

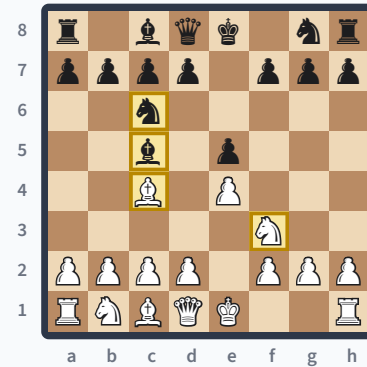


1.e4 e5

- The 4 middle squares are the most important on the board. Pieces there reach everywhere.
- Start with a **centre pawn** (e4 or d4) and aim your pieces at the centre.

2. Develop Your Pieces

KNIGHTS & BISHOPS OUT

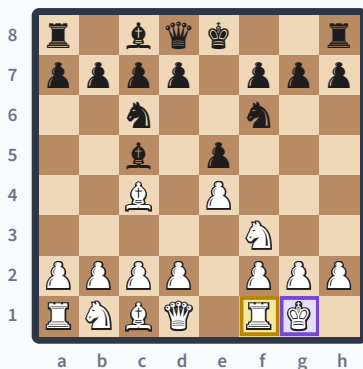


2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5

- Bring out **Knights and Bishops** first, toward the centre. Usually Knights before Bishops.
- Move each piece once. Keep the Queen at home for now.

3. Castle by Move 7

KING SAFE



4.0-0 Nf6

- Castling tucks the King behind a wall of pawns and brings a Rook toward the middle.
- A King left in the centre is an easy target. Aim to castle **within 7 moves**.

4. Warning: Legal's Mate

GREED LOSES



5.Nxe5! Bxd1?? 6.Bxf7+ Ke7 7.Nd5#

- After 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 d6 3.Bc4 h6? 4.Nc3 Bg4, Black wasted a move and didn't develop the Knights.
- Black grabs the Queen, but White's Knights and Bishop mate. **Development beats greed!**

Opening Checklist

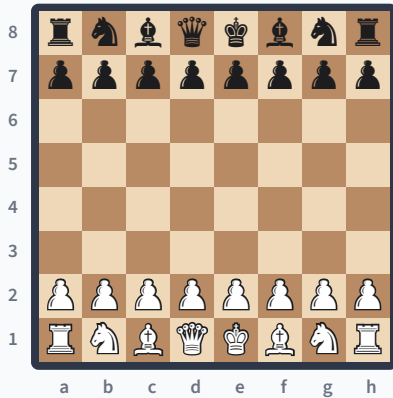
1. Put a **pawn in the centre** (e4 or d4).
2. **Knights and Bishops** out, toward the centre.
3. **Castle** within the first 7 moves.
4. Don't move the **same piece twice**.
5. Don't bring the **Queen** out early.
6. Before grabbing: **what is my opponent threatening?**

PUZZLES: OPENINGS

Centre, develop, castle, and don't be greedy

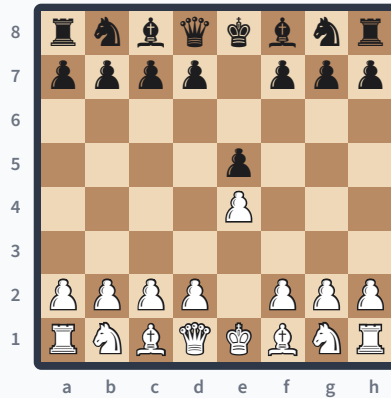
Lesson 13 · Openings Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

- 1** Best first move for White? A) a4 B) e4 C) Na3



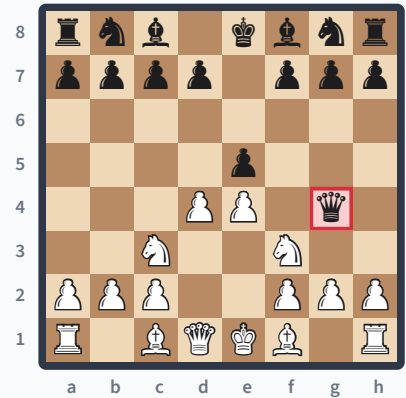
Answer: _____

- 2** 1.e4 e5. Best 2nd move for White? A) Qh5 B) Nf3 C) a4



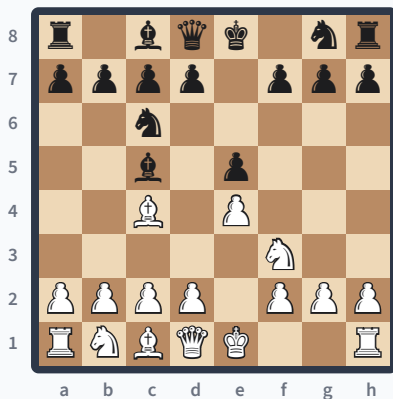
Answer: _____

- 3** Black moved the Queen three times. Which opening rule did Black break?



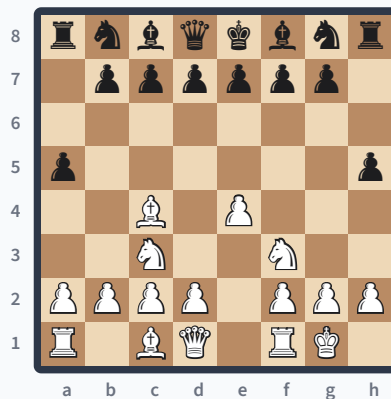
Answer: _____

- 4** White to move. Can White castle kingside now? Why?



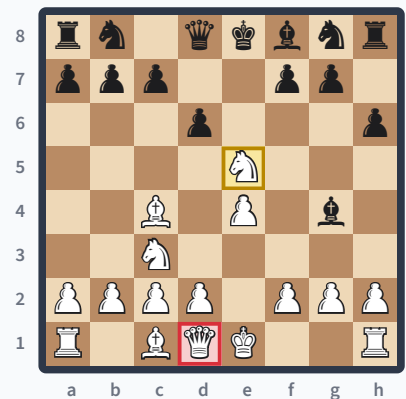
Answer: _____

- 5** Which side is better developed? Count the pieces out!



Answer: _____

- 6** Black to move. Should Black grab the Queen with 5...Bxd1?



Answer: _____

Tip: centre pawn, Knights and Bishops out, castle by move 7, Queen stays home.

Score: ____ / 6

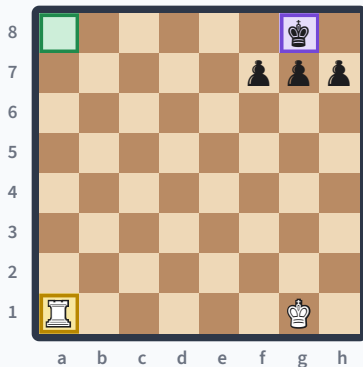
MATE IN ONE

Spot the checkmate • Four patterns to know

Lesson 14 • Attack
Beginner Handouts

1. Back-Rank Mate

ROOK ON THE LAST ROW

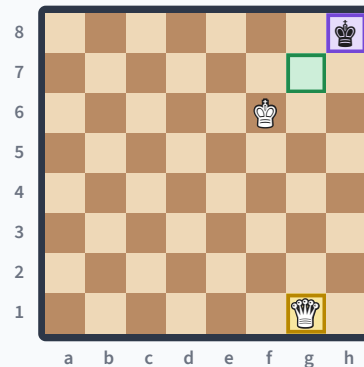


1. Ra8#

- Black's own pawns block the King in. A Rook on the back row is **checkmate**.
- Watch out for this against YOUR King too!

2. Kiss of Death

QUEEN + HELPER

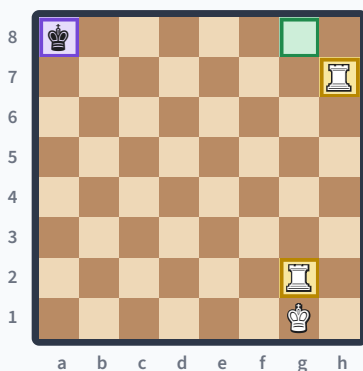


1. Qg7#

- The Queen goes right next to the King, **guarded by her own King**.
- The King can't take her, and every square around it is covered.

3. Two Rooks

ROOK + ROOK

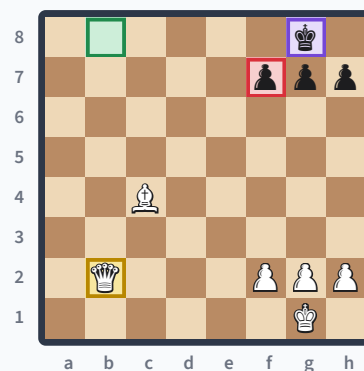


1. Rh8#

- One Rook guards the 7th row; the other checks on the 8th.
- This is the ladder mate you know, finished in one move.

4. Try Every Check

ONE CHECK IS MATE



1. Qb8# (1. Bxf7+? is just a check)

- White has two checks. **1. Bxf7+** lets the King take the Bishop.
- **1. Qb8#** is mate: the King has no square and nothing can block.

Finding Mate in One

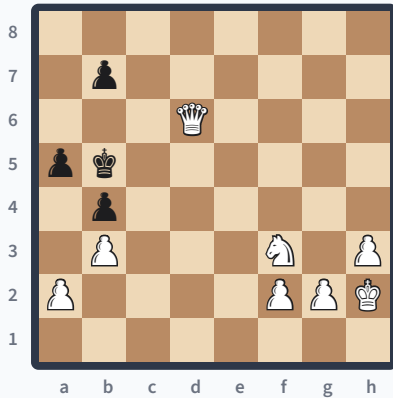
1. List **every check** you can give.
2. For each check, ask: can the King **move**, can something **block**, can the checker be **captured**?
3. Three times "no" means **checkmate**!

PUZZLES: MATE IN ONE

Six positions from real Lichess games

Lesson 14 · Attack Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

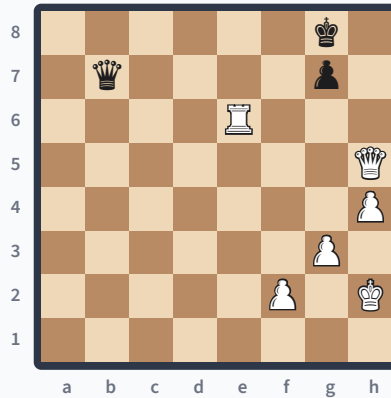
1 White to move. Checkmate in 1!



White (1515) v Black (1379) · 10+0
lichess.org/atgsbOBS

Answer: _____

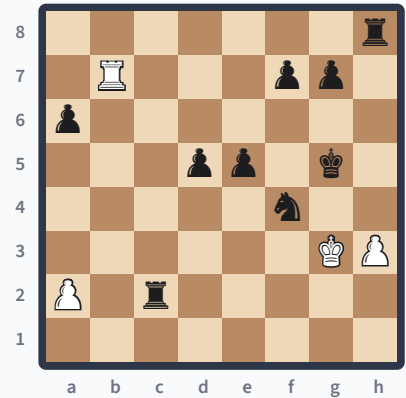
2 White to move. Checkmate in 1!



White (2006) v Black (1960) · 10+0
lichess.org/yI6cT8yt

Answer: _____

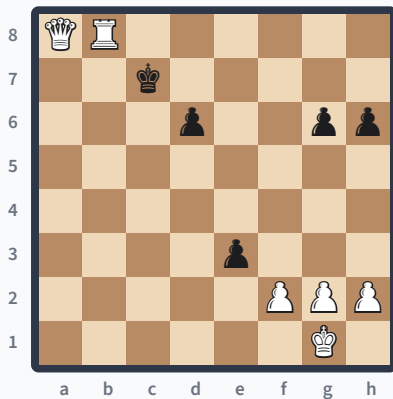
3 Black to move. Checkmate in 1!



White (1537) v Black (1453) · 20+10
lichess.org/ooVLKWzi

Answer: _____

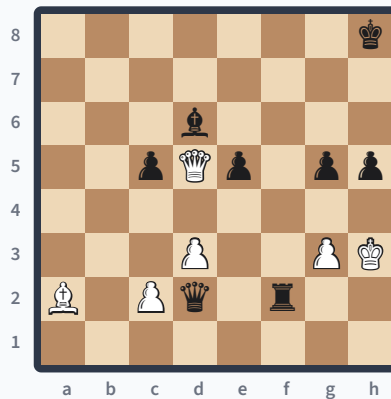
4 White to move. Checkmate in 1!



White (2020) v Black (1788) · 10+0
lichess.org/B2PZqrVE

Answer: _____

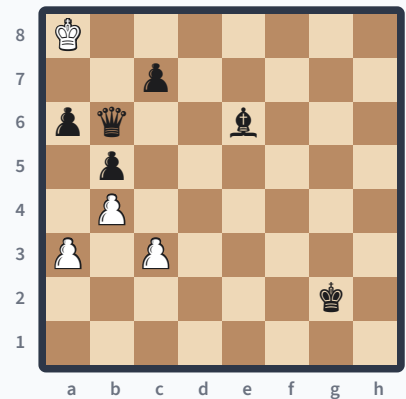
5 White to move. Checkmate in 1!



White (1456) v Black (1472) · 8+0
lichess.org/RifoRB7V

Answer: _____

6 Black to move. Checkmate in 1!



White (1646) v Black (1860) · 10+0
lichess.org/xiHZ2Yz5

Answer: _____

Tip: list every check, then ask: can the King move, block or capture? Three "no"s = mate!

Score: ____ / 6

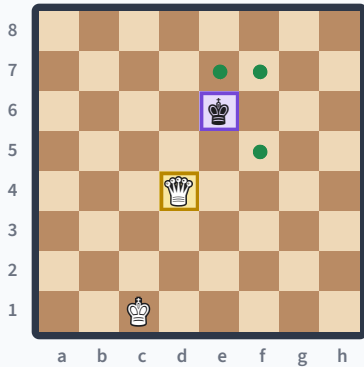
QUEEN + KING CHECKMATE

Box the King in, walk your King over, then mate

Lesson 15 · Basics
Beginner Handouts

1. Build a Box

A KNIGHT'S JUMP AWAY

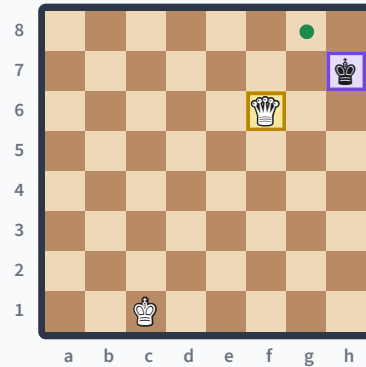


Queen d4 vs. King e6

- Put the Queen a **Knight's jump** away from the enemy King. It can't cross her lines (dots = its only squares).
- Each time the King moves, follow it, keeping that same Knight's-jump distance.

2. Squeeze to the Edge

NOW STOP THE QUEEN

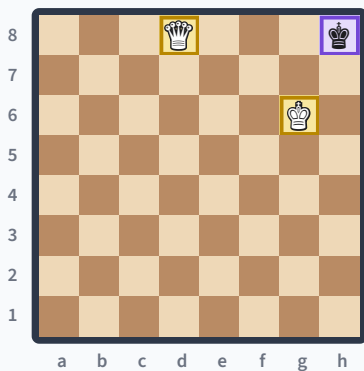


Queen f6 vs. King h7

- Keep shrinking the box until the King is stuck in the corner, going h7 → g8 → h7.
- Now **stop moving the Queen** and walk your own King over. The Queen can't mate alone.

3. Checkmate!

Qd8#

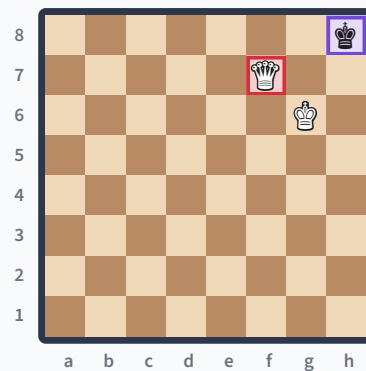


Queen d5, King g6 → 1.Qd8#

- Your King on **g6** guards g7 and h7. The Queen checks along the back row.
- Qa8#** works too. Those are the only two mates here. Most other moves are stalemate!

4. Don't Stalemate!

Qf7?? = DRAW



Same position: 1.Qf7?? stalemate

- Black is not in check, but g8, g7 and h7 are all covered. No legal move: **DRAW**.
- Qe6, Qc4 and even Kh6 are stalemate too. Before each move ask: "Check, or a square left?"

The Queen Mate Recipe

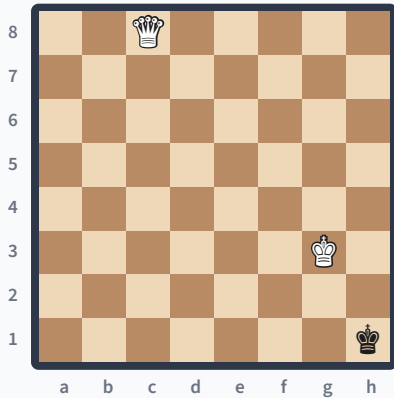
- Box:** Queen a Knight's jump from the King. Follow it and squeeze it to the edge.
- Bring the King:** once the enemy King is stuck on the edge, stop the Queen and march your King up.
- Mate, don't stalemate:** give check on the edge (or the Kiss of Death), and always leave a square until then.

PUZZLES: QUEEN MATES

White to move and checkmate in 1. Don't stalemate!

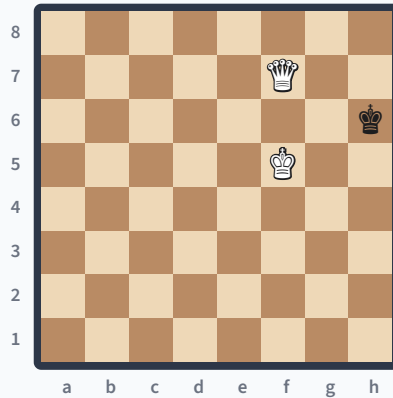
Lesson 15 · Basics Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

1 White to move. Checkmate in 1!



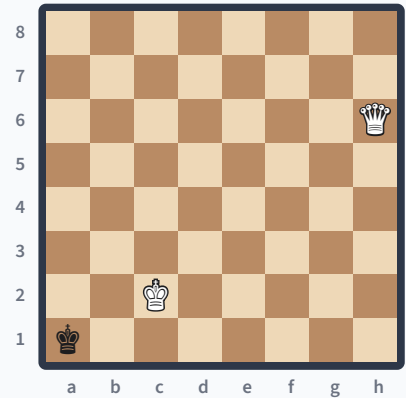
Answer: _____

2 White to move. Checkmate in 1! (Don't move the King!)



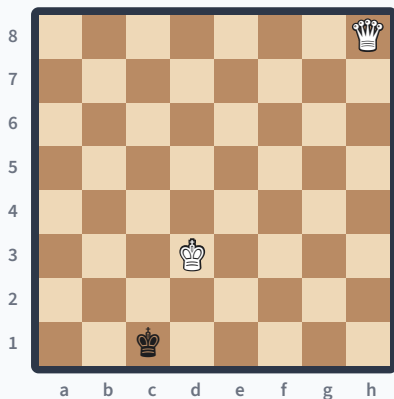
Answer: _____

3 White to move. Checkmate in 1!



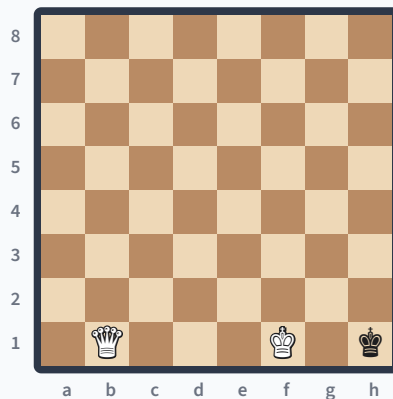
Answer: _____

4 White to move. Checkmate in 1!



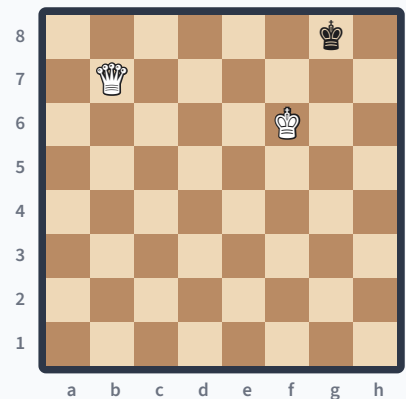
Answer: _____

5 White to move. Checkmate in 1! Watch out for stalemate!



Answer: _____

6 White to move. Checkmate in 1!



Answer: _____

Tip: a mate must be CHECK. If your move is not check and Black can't move, it's stalemate!

Score: ____ / 6

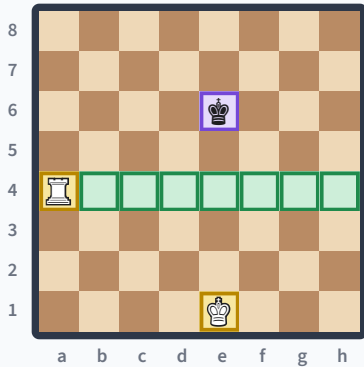
ROOK + KING CHECKMATE

Cut off, face off, check • Push the King to the edge

Lesson 16 • Basics
Beginner Handouts

1. Cut Off the King

A ROOK WALL

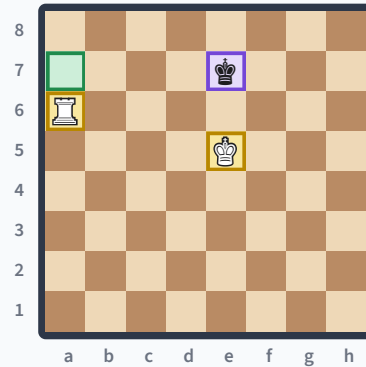


Rook a4: King stays on ranks 5–8

- The Rook on the 4th rank is a **wall**: Black's King can't cross it.
- Keep the Rook far from the enemy King, then march your own King up.

2. Kings Face Off, Rook Checks

1.Ra7+

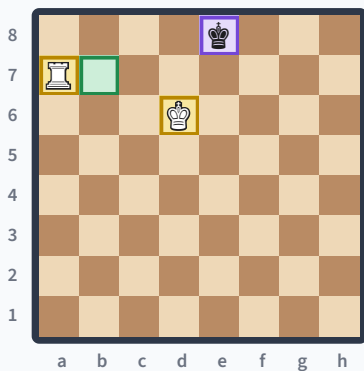


White to move: 1.Ra7+

- When the Kings **face each other** (e5 and e7), check with the Rook.
- Black's King must step back one row, to the 8th. Repeat until it's on the edge.

3. The Waiting Move

1.Rb7! PASS

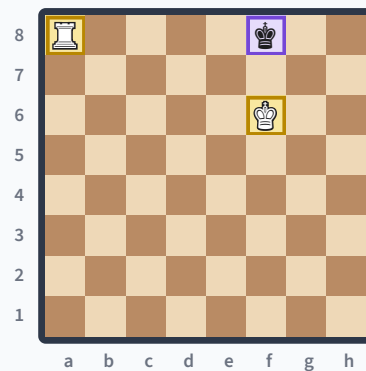


1.Rb7! Kd8 2.Rb8#

- Kings not facing each other? Don't chase: make a **quiet Rook move** along its row.
- If Black steps in front of your King (Kd8), mate! If 1...Kf8, walk your King across and repeat.

4. Checkmate!

RA8#



After 1.Ra8#

- Kings face each other (f6 and f8). Your King guards e7, f7 and g7.
- The Rook checks along the whole back row: no escape. Checkmate!

The Rook Mate Recipe

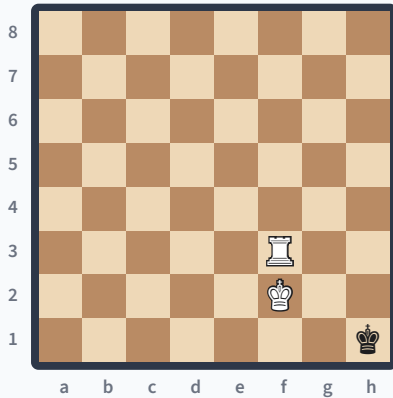
1. **Cut off**: use the Rook as a wall to trap the King in part of the board.
2. **Face off, then check**: bring your King in front of the enemy King, then check with the Rook to push it back one row.
3. **Waiting move**: if the King steps aside, make a quiet Rook move. Rook attacked? Move it far away along the same row.

PUZZLES: ROOK MATES

Checkmate with King and Rook

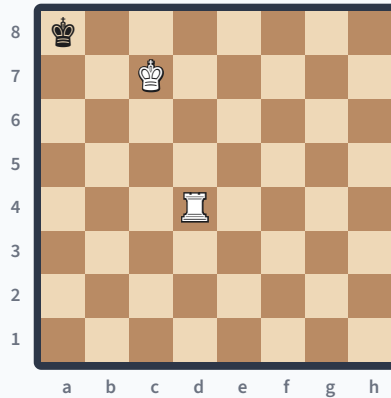
Lesson 16 · Basics Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

1 White to move. Checkmate in 1!



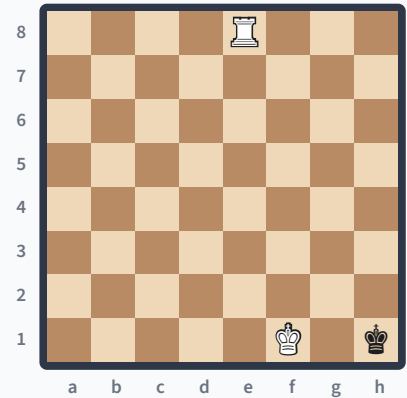
Answer: _____

2 White to move. Checkmate in 1!



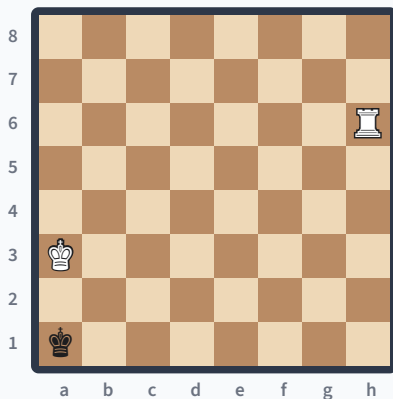
Answer: _____

3 White to move. Checkmate in 1! Watch out for stalemate!



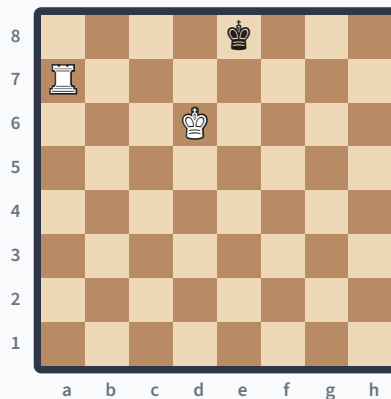
Answer: _____

4 White to move. Checkmate in 1! Watch out for stalemate!



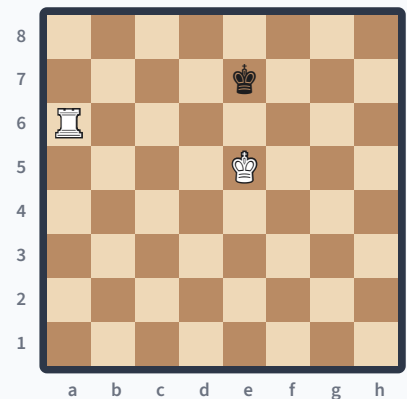
Answer: _____

5 Kings are NOT facing each other. Make a waiting move with the Rook.



Answer: _____

6 Kings face each other. Which check pushes Black's King back?



Answer: _____

Tip: Rook mates happen on the edge, usually with the Kings facing each other.

Score: ____ / 6

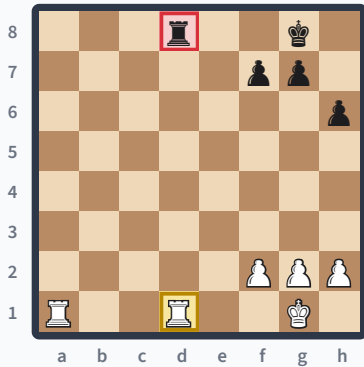
WINNING WHEN YOU'RE AHEAD

You won a piece. Now finish the job!

Lesson 17 · Endgame
Beginner Handouts

1. Trade Pieces, Not Pawns

SWAP DOWN

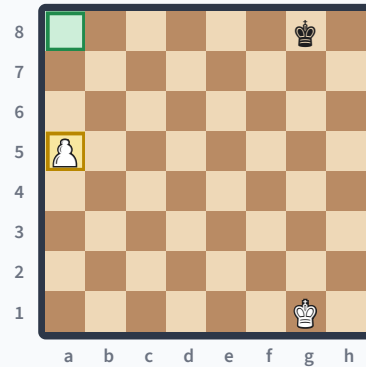


1.Rxd8+ Kh7: a whole Rook up

- Every trade makes your extra piece count for more. With fewer pieces, they have fewer tricks.
- **Keep your pawns:** one of them can become a Queen.

2. Push the Passed Pawn

NOBODY CAN STOP IT

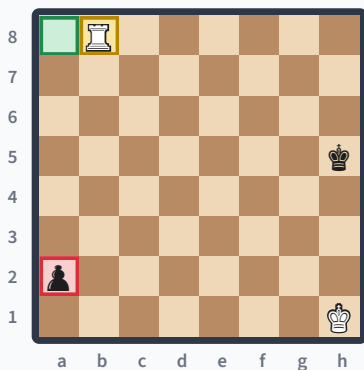


1.a6! and the pawn runs to a8

- A **passed pawn** has no enemy pawn in front of it or beside it.
- The black King is too far away to catch it. Push!

3. Stop Their Last Hope

WATCH THEIR PAWNS

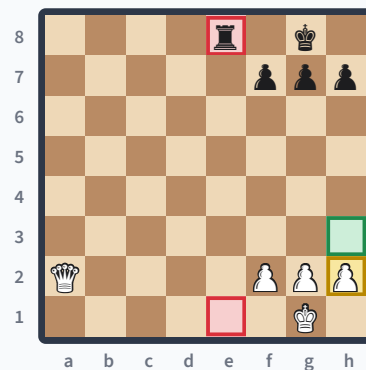


1.Ra8! (or 1.Rb1) stops the pawn

- You're a Rook up, but Black's pawn is one step from a new Queen.
- Put your Rook **behind the pawn** or on the promotion square first.

4. Don't Relax!

DO THEIR CCT



Black threatens ...Re1#! 1.h3

- White is a Queen up, but Black threatens **back-rank mate**.
- **1.h3** (or 1.g3 or 1.f4) gives the King an escape square. Then win.

The Winning Recipe

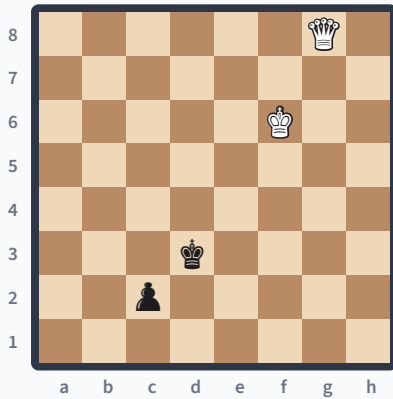
1. **Stay safe first:** do CCT for your opponent before every move.
2. **Trade pieces, keep pawns,** and push a passed pawn to make a Queen.
3. **Go for mate,** and before every quiet move, check that the enemy King still has a move (no stalemate!).

PUZZLES: WINNING WHEN AHEAD

Six positions from real Lichess games

Lesson 17 · Endgame Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

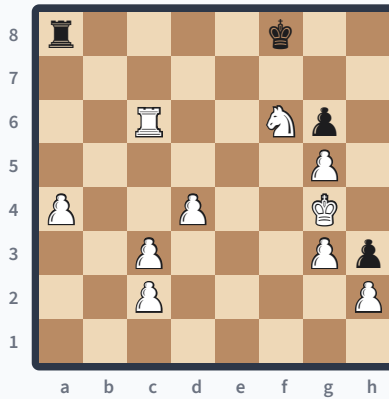
- 1** White is winning. Find the move that keeps it easy!



White (1937) v Black (2090) · 10+0
lichess.org/zPwZcNlm

Answer: _____

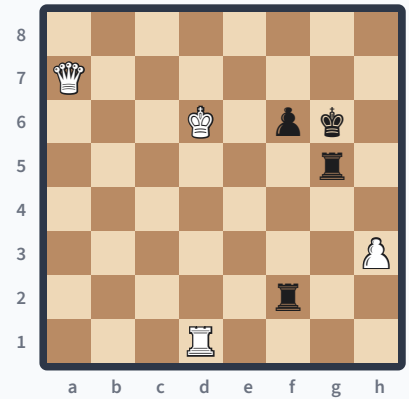
- 2** White is winning. Find the move that keeps it easy!



White (1718) v Black (1581) · 10+0
lichess.org/dPuyBWEq

Answer: _____

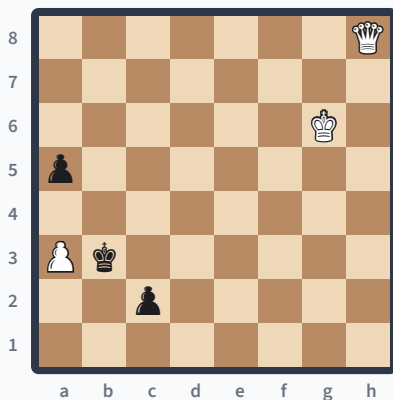
- 3** White is winning. Find the move that keeps it easy!



White (1801) v Black (1816) · 10+0
lichess.org/ExYyvhzz

Answer: _____

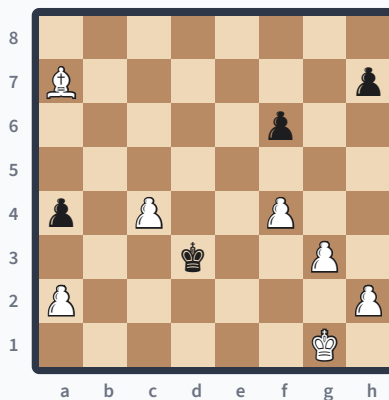
- 4** White is winning. Find the move that keeps it easy!



White (1529) v Black (1531) · 5+8
lichess.org/jZSyDeNl

Answer: _____

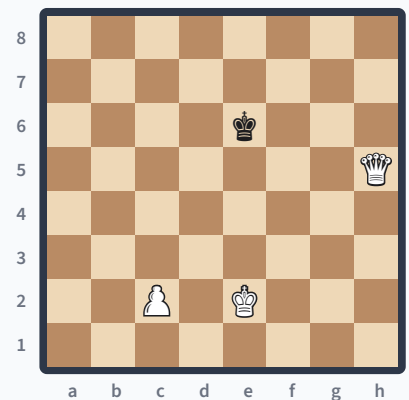
- 5** White is winning. Find the move that keeps it easy!



White (1297) v Black (1319) · 10+0
lichess.org/uptBaJTj

Answer: _____

- 6** White is winning. Find the move that keeps it easy!



White (1716) v Black (1850) · 10+0
lichess.org/HJSXS1DQ

Answer: _____

Tip: first stop their threats and their pawns, then trade pieces, push your pawn, and go for mate.

Score: ____ / 6

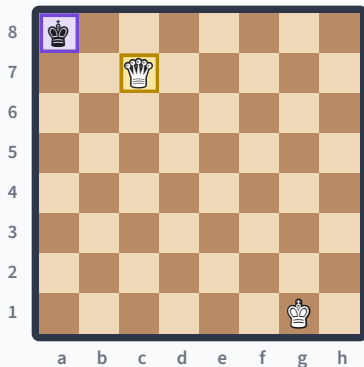
HOW GAMES ARE DRAWN

Five ways a game ends with nobody winning (½-½)

Lesson 18 · Defence
Beginner Handouts

1. Stalemate

NO MOVES, NO CHECK

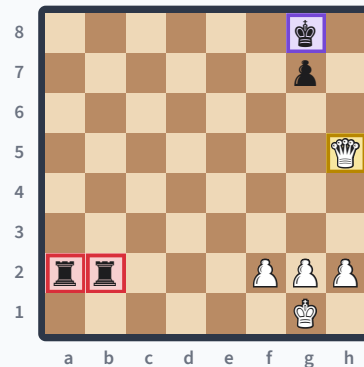


Black to move: stalemate

- The player to move is **not in check** but has **no legal move**.
- The game is over at once: a draw (see Lesson 8).

2. Repetition

SAME POSITION 3 TIMES

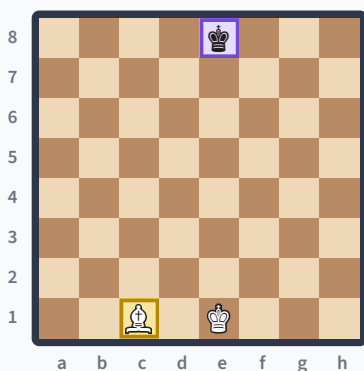


Qe8+ Kh7 Qh5+ Kg8 Qe8+ ...

- Black is two Rooks up, but White checks forever ("perpetual check"). Black can't escape.
- When the same position appears **3 times**, a player can claim a draw from the arbiter.

3. Not Enough Pieces

MATE IS IMPOSSIBLE



King + Bishop vs. King

- Some pieces can never checkmate: **King + Bishop, King + Knight**, or just two Kings.
- When checkmate becomes impossible, the game is a draw straight away.

4. 50 Moves & Agreement

TWO MORE WAYS

The 50-Move Rule

If both players make **50 moves** in a row with **no capture** and **no pawn move**, a player can claim a draw. It stops a game going on forever when nobody can make progress.

Draw by Agreement

1. Make your move on the board.
2. Say: **"Would you like a draw?"**
3. Press your clock.
4. Your opponent says yes, or just plays a move (that means no).

Some junior events don't allow draw offers. Check with the arbiter.

Winning or Losing? Use the Draw Rules!

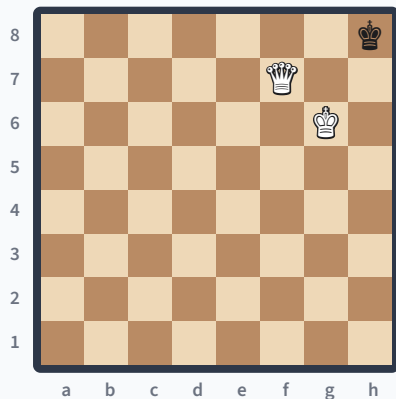
1. **When you're winning:** avoid stalemate, don't repeat moves, and keep capturing or pushing pawns to beat the 50-move rule.
2. **When you're losing:** look for a stalemate trick or a perpetual check. A draw is much better than a loss!
3. **Not sure if it's a draw?** Pause the clock and ask the arbiter.

PUZZLES: DRAW OR NOT?

Is the game over? Who wins, or is it a draw?

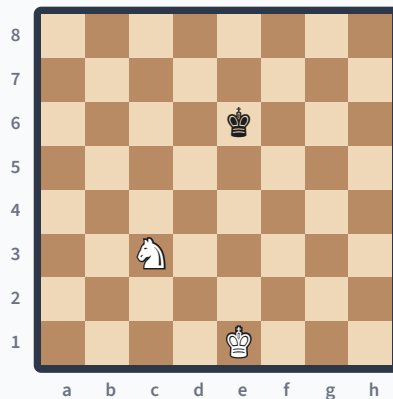
Lesson 18 · Defence Puzzles
Beginner Handouts

1 Black to move. Draw or not? Why?



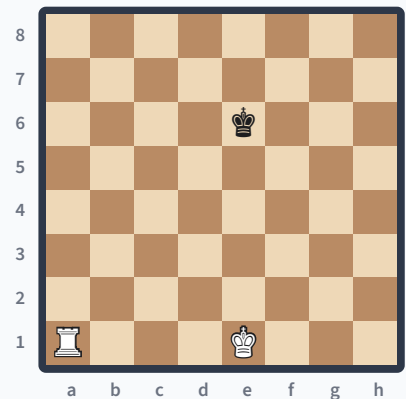
Answer: _____

2 Draw or not? Why?



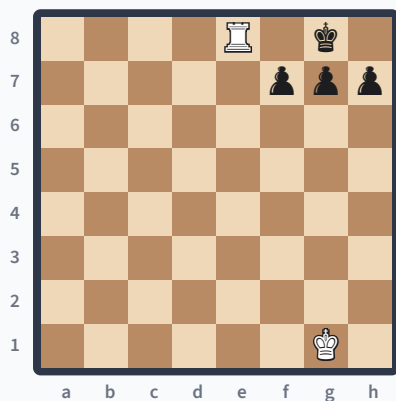
Answer: _____

3 Draw or not? Why?



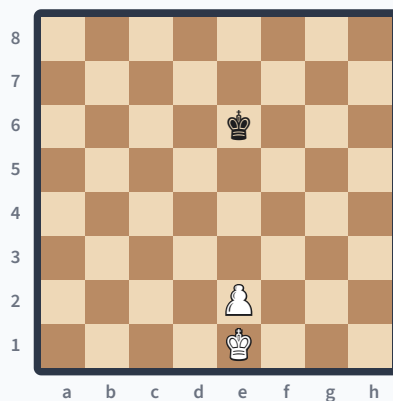
Answer: _____

4 Black to move. Draw or not? Why?



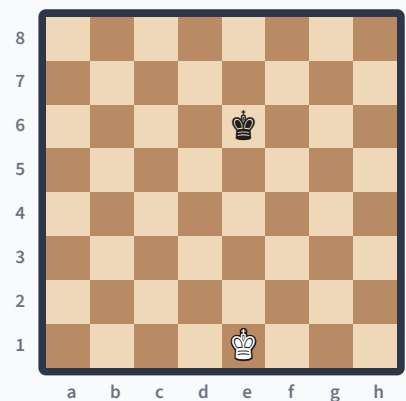
Answer: _____

5 Draw or not? Why?



Answer: _____

6 Draw or not? Why?



Answer: _____

Tip: check for stalemate, then ask: does anyone have enough pieces to checkmate?

Score: ____ / 6

TOURNAMENT MANNERS

Touch-move, the clock and being a good sport

Lesson 19 · Rules
Beginner Handouts

1. Touch-Move

TOUCH IT, MOVE IT

- Touch one of **your** pieces: you must move it (if it has a legal move).
- Touch one of your **opponent's** pieces: you must capture it (if you can).
- Let go of a piece on a square: it **stays there**. No take-backs!
- Castling: touch the **King first**. Touching the Rook first means you must make a Rook move.

Think with your eyes, not your hands. Sit on your hands if you need to!

2. Fixing a Wobbly Piece

SAY IT FIRST

- A piece isn't centred on its square? Say "**I adjust**" (or "j'adoube") **before** you touch it.
- Only adjust on **your own turn**.
- Never adjust your opponent's pieces on their turn. Ask them, or ask the arbiter.

Say: "I adjust" → then touch

3. Using the Clock

MOVE, THEN PRESS

- Make your move, **then** press the clock, with the **same hand** you moved with.
- Press gently. No slamming, and keep your hand off the clock between moves.
- Write your move on the scoresheet after you have played it.
- If your time runs out, you usually **lose**, even with more pieces. Watch your clock!

4. Be a Good Sport

WIN OR LOSE

- **Shake hands** before the game and after it, whatever the result.
- To give up: say "**I resign**" and offer your hand. Don't just walk away.
- Phones and watches: switched **off** and in your bag.
- Won? Be kind. Lost? Say "well played" and learn from it.

Good to Know

1. You **don't have to say "check"**. It's your opponent's job to notice.
2. **Promotion:** put the new Queen (or other piece) on the square before you press the clock. No spare Queen? **Pause the clock and ask the arbiter for one**. An upside-down Rook is a Rook, not a Queen!
3. Your opponent made an illegal move, or you're not sure of a rule? **Pause the clock and call the arbiter**.

DURING THE COMPETITION

Food, quiet, problems at the board, and finishing your game

Lesson 20 · Rules
Beginner Handouts

1. Food & Drink

WATER IS OK

- Bring snacks and drinks, but have them **away from the board** (in the break area).
- A bottle of **water** at the board is fine. Keep it on the floor or away from the pieces.
- No crumbs or sticky fingers on the pieces. Keep the table clean for everyone.

2. Quiet, Please

NO TALKING

- **No talking** during games: not to your opponent, friends, parents or coach.
- No helping others, and no asking for help.
- Finished early? Watch other games silently from a step away, or leave the playing hall.

The only words you need: "I adjust", a draw offer, "I resign", and calling the arbiter.

3. A Problem at the Board?

PAUSE · CALL · EXPLAIN

Your opponent kicks you under the table, talks too much, or something else feels wrong:

1. **Pause the clock.**
2. **Raise your hand** and call the arbiter.
3. **Explain calmly** what happened.
4. **Let the arbiter decide.** Don't argue with your opponent yourself.

4. When the Game Is Over

RECORD THE RESULT

1. **Pause the clock** and shake hands.
2. **Call the arbiter** (or go together to the results table).
3. **Check the result** is recorded correctly: 1-0, 0-1 or $\frac{1}{2}$ - $\frac{1}{2}$.
4. Both players **sign** the scoresheets if asked.
5. Set the pieces back up and leave quietly. Other games are still going!

The Arbiter Is Your Friend

1. The arbiter is the referee. They are there to help you, and you will **never** get in trouble for asking.
2. Unsure about a rule, a draw, an illegal move or your opponent's behaviour? **Pause the clock and call.**
3. The arbiter's decision is final. Accept it politely and carry on playing.

SOLUTIONS

All puzzle answers · Each game link is printed under its puzzle

No peeking
until you've tried!

1. Setting Up the Board p. 2

- 1 White King and Queen swapped (Queen goes on d1)
- 2 Board turned the wrong way (h1 must be light)
- 3 White c1-Bishop and c2-pawn swapped
- 4 Nothing wrong!
- 5 Black Knights and Bishops swapped
- 6 White Rooks and Knights swapped

2. Writing Down Your Game p. 4

- 1 f5
- 2 A = b3, B = g6
- 3 d5
- 4 Nf3
- 5 Bxf7+
- 6 Qxf7# (Scholar's Mate!)

3. The Pawn p. 6

- 1 exd5 (the e5-pawn is straight ahead, so it can't be taken)
- 2 No: it is blocked and has nothing to capture
- 3 Three: a3, a4 and cxb5
- 4 White: both need 5 moves, but White goes first
- 5 b6! If axb6 then c6!, if cxb6 then a6!, and a pawn breaks through
- 6 gxh8=Q: take the Rook AND get a Queen

4. The Rook p. 8

- 1 Ten (b4 capture, c4, d4, f4, g4, h4, e5, e3, e2, e1)
- 2 Rxd6: the Knight is free (the h1-Bishop is guarded by the g3-Knight)
- 3 Three moves: Rxa5, Rxe5, Rxe8
- 4 Re7 attacks both the Bishop and the Knight
- 5 Rxg4 (the c4-pawn is guarded by b3)
- 6 Rb8#

5. The Bishop p. 10

- 1 Never: c1 is a dark square and a8 is light
- 2 Ten (Bxb7, c6, c4, e6, f7, g8, e4, f3, g2, h1)
- 3 Bxb7 wins a free Rook (the f3-Knight is guarded by the g4-pawn)
- 4 Bc4 attacks the Rook and the Knight
- 5 Bxh3 (the c4-pawn is guarded by b3)
- 6 Bd5#

6. The Queen p. 12

- 1 Twenty-four (including Qxb6)
- 2 Qh5 attacks the Rook on f3 and the Knight on f7
- 3 Qxg7 wins a free Bishop (the d8-Rook is guarded by the b7-Knight)
- 4 Qg7# (Kiss of Death)
- 5 Qxa5 (d3 is guarded by e2, g5 by h4)
- 6 Qd8# or Qa8#

7. The Knight p. 14

- 1 Four moves (for example a1-c2-e3-d1-b2)
- 2 Four: c3, f2, g3, g5 (its own pawns block the rest)
- 3 Nc4 attacks the Rook and the Bishop
- 4 Nc6+! Check to the King, and the Queen on e5 falls next move
- 5 Six moves
- 6 Nf7#

8. The King p. 16

- 1 Stalemate: not in check, no legal move, so it's a draw
- 2 Checkmate
- 3 Check: the King escapes to h7
- 4 No! The f4-Knight protects the Queen and the King has no square: checkmate
- 5 Kd1, Kd2, Kf1, Kf2 (move), Bxe5 (capture), Ne2 (block)
- 6 Rd8#

9. Castling p. 18

- 1 Yes, both sides
- 2 Queenside only: the Bishop attacks f1, which the King must cross
- 3 No: White is in check
- 4 Queenside only: the Knight on g1 is in the way
- 5 Yes, queenside! b1 is attacked, but only the Rook crosses it, which is allowed
- 6 No: the King would land on g1, attacked by the Rook

10. En Passant & Promotion p. 20

- 1 dxc6 (en passant)
- 2 No: en passant is only allowed right after a TWO-square pawn move
- 3 d8=N+! It checks the King and attacks the Queen
- 4 b8=R (b8=Q?? is stalemate!)
- 5 e8=Q# (e8=R# also mates)
- 6 bxa8=Q: take the Rook AND get a Queen

11. Is It Safe? p. 22

- 1 Nxe4: the Bishop is free (the b5-Knight is guarded by the a6-pawn)
- 2 Yes: 2 attackers vs 1 defender. Nxe5 Nxe5 Rxe5
- 3 No: now it's 2 vs 2 (the f6-pawn joined in)
- 4 Nxd5! Knight for Bishop is fair. Rxd5?? exd5 loses the Rook
- 5 Nxh5 wins the Queen! (the e4-Rook is guarded by d3)
- 6 No: 4...Kxf7, and White gave a Bishop (3) for a pawn (1)

12. Checks, Captures, Threats p. 24

- 1 32...Nd3+ 33.Ke2 Nxb2: a fork
- 2 27...Rxe5: the piece was unguarded
- 3 White threatens Qg7#. 28...Qxg4+ is the only move
- 4 18.Qe5+ Qe7 19.Qxh8+: a fork
- 5 26...Rxe1+: the piece was unguarded
- 6 Black threatens ...Qg2#. 33.Qf1 (or Kf1)

13. Opening Basics p. 26

- 1 B) e4: it takes the centre and lets the Queen and Bishop out
- 2 B) Nf3: it develops a piece and attacks e5
- 3 Don't bring the Queen out early / don't move the same piece again and again
- 4 Yes: King and Rook haven't moved, f1 and g1 are empty and safe, so O-O
- 5 White: 3 pieces out and castled. Black has only moved pawns
- 6 No! 5...Bxd1?? 6.Bxf7+ Ke7 7.Nd5# is Legal's Mate

14. Mate in One p. 28

- 1 44.Nd4#
- 2 51.Re8#
- 3 37...Rxh3#
- 4 35.Qb7#
- 5 45.Qg8#
- 6 50...Bd5#

15. Queen + King Mate p. 30

- 1 Qc1# (Qc5?? is stalemate)
- 2 Qg6# (Kf6??, Kf4?? and Kg4?? are stalemate)
- 3 Qa6# (Qe6?? is stalemate)
- 4 Qa1#
- 5 Qh7# (Qc2??, Qb2??, Qa2?? and Qb8?? are stalemate)
- 6 Qg7# (Kiss of Death)

16. Rook + King Mate p. 32

- 1 Rh3#
- 2 Ra4#
- 3 Rh8# (Re2?? is stalemate)
- 4 Rh1# (Rb6?? is stalemate)
- 5 A far-away Rook move along the 7th row, e.g. Rh7 or Rb7. If 1...Kd8, then Rh8# (or Rb8#)
- 6 Ra7+ pushes the King back to the 8th row

17. Winning When You're Ahead p. 34

- 1 63.Qg5! stops the pawn: c1 is covered
- 2 38.d5! push the passed pawn
- 3 53.Qxf2! take the free Rook
- 4 49.Qa1! stops the pawn: c1 is covered
- 5 31.c5! push the passed pawn
- 6 56.Qg6+! box the King in, then mate

18. How Games Are Drawn p. 36

- 1 Draw: stalemate
- 2 Draw: King + Knight can't checkmate
- 3 Not a draw: King + Rook can checkmate, so keep playing
- 4 Not a draw: it's checkmate, White wins
- 5 Not a draw yet: the pawn could promote, so keep playing
- 6 Draw: only the Kings are left